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A Śaiva Interpretation of the *Satkāryavāda*: The Sāṃkhya Notion of *Abhivyakti* and Its Transformation in the Pratyabhijñā Treatise

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Abstract It is a well-known fact that the Śaiva nondualistic philosopher Utpaladeva (fl. c. 925–975) adopted the Sāṃkhya principle according to which the effect must exist in some way before the operation of its cause (*satkāryavāda*). Johannes Bronkhorst has highlighted the paradox inherent in this appropriation: Utpaladeva is a staunch supporter of the *satkāryavāda*, but whereas Sāṃkhya authors consider it as a means of proving the existence of an unconscious matter, the Śaiva exploits it so as to establish his monistic idealism, in perfect contradiction with the Sāṃkhya dualism of matter and consciousness. How does Utpaladeva achieve this complete reversal of meaning of the *satkāryavāda*? The present article argues that the elliptical verses of the *Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikā* dealing with this issue have been partly misunderstood so far due to the loss of Utpaladeva's own detailed commentary (*Vivṛti*) on this passage: Abhinavagupta's two commentaries, however terse in this respect, clearly show that a crucial part of Utpaladeva's reasoning remains implicit in the verses. The article therefore attempts to reconstruct the gist of Utpaladeva's strategy by having recourse to various other Śaiva sources, including Somānanda's *Śivadṛṣṭi* and Utpaladeva's own commentary thereon. This examination shows that Utpaladeva's appropriation of the *satkāryavāda* rests on a profound transformation of the Sāṃkhya notions of manifestation (*abhivyakti*) and potentiality (*śakti*), and that his criticism of the Sāṃkhya understanding of causality might target the Śaiva dualists as well as Sāṃkhya authors.

Keywords Utpaladeva · Abhinavagupta · Somānanda · Sāṃkhya · *Satkāryavāda* · *Abhivyakti*

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Introduction: Why Abhinavagupta's Commentaries on Verses 2.4.3—4 in the Pratyabhijñā Treatise Deserve a Close Examination

How can an effect be produced by a cause or a series of causes? Is this production the arising of a new entity, or did this effect already exist in some latent form before becoming manifest? The problem of the ontological status of the effect before its production is one of the main points of disagreement—and therefore of creativity as far as philosophical concepts are concerned—in the history of Indian philosophy. The present article does not claim to provide any comprehensive account of this complex controversy and its many ontological, linguistic and metaphysical implications[1]; it merely attempts to understand how the Śaiva nondualist Utpaladeva (fl. c. 925–975) has appropriated the famous Sāṃkhya "theory [according to which] the effect exists [before the operation of its cause]" (*satkāryavāda*) in his Pratyabhijñā treatise.

The adoption of this Sāṃkhyan doctrinal feature is not surprising in itself: Śaiva traditions (both dualistic and nondualistic) have early on integrated many aspects of Sāṃkhya to their metaphysics, cosmology and psychology,[2] so much so in fact that Śaiva authors sometimes feel the need to specify that "the Sāṃkhyas too" hold theses that were obviously borrowed from them.[3] From this point of view, Utpaladeva's borrowing of the *satkāryavāda* is in keeping with the general Śaiva attitude towards Sāṃkhya.[4] But if we consider that the Sāṃkhyan theory of causation, whether it was originally designed to justify the thesis that only the unconscious matter (*pradhāna*) acts or not, was certainly considered by later Sāṃkhya authors as the main argument for the agency of matter,[5] Utpaladeva's position becomes quite paradoxical, since one of his main goals in writing the Pratyabhijñā treatise is to demonstrate that Śiva, understood as a universal and all-encompassing consciousness, is the sole agent. Johannes Bronkhorst has emphasized this paradox:

> Utpaladeva gives a new interpretation to the *satkāryavāda* and to the problem of origination. It fits his religious views, but has as inevitable consequence that God, or the real self, is an agent, in fact the only agent that exists. This turns the world view of the Sāṃkhya and other philosophies on its head.[6]

[1] For a particularly interesting overall interpretation of the debate which highlights the linguistic aspects of the problem and the fact that the controversy rests on the assumption of a "correspondence" between language and reality, see Bronkhorst (2011).

[2] See e.g. Torella (1999) and Bansat-Boudon and Tripathi (2011, pp. 45–46 and 52–56).

[3] See Torella (1999, p. 560), on Aghoraśiva's assertion that "the Sāṃkhyas too" acknowledge the hierarchy of *tattva*-s.

[4] Thus the Śaivasiddhānta, the dualistic Śaiva tradition so powerful in Utpaladeva's time, had also adopted the *satkāryavāda* (see Goodall 2004, p. 157, fn. 70).

[5] The hypothesis that the *satkāryavāda* was developed so as to meet the criticism against the reasons adduced for the existence of matter was brought forward in Frauwallner (1953, pp. 385–386), and is challenged in Wezler (1987, pp. 179 ff). Whatever the case, the SK commentaries clearly present SK 9, which expounds the *satkāryavāda*, as the justification of SK10, which deals with the notion of an active matter.

[6] Bronkhorst (1996, p. 616). See also Bronkhorst (2011, pp. 68–70), which mentions Utpaladeva's position as "an interesting variant of *satkāryavāda*".

Alex Watson has rightly pointed out that this conception of the Self as an agent should not be regarded as a novelty introduced by Utpaladeva, insofar as it is already found at the core of the Śaiva tradition that precedes him, whether dualist or not.[7] What is more surprising, however, is the fact that Utpaladeva indeed turns the Sāṃkhya world view on its head: as Johannes Bronkhorst has shown in his insightful analyses of Utpaladeva's verses and *Vṛtti* on the *satkāryavāda*, the Śaiva nondualist exploits the Sāṃkhyan principle that the effect must exist before the causal operation so as to demonstrate *that the Sāṃkhya is wrong in considering that consciousness is inactive while matter acts*, and the purpose of his defense of the *satkāryavāda* is to show that the very acceptance of this principle entails the admission that the unconscious cannot be a cause.[8] But how does he achieve this complete reversal of meaning of the *satkāryavāda* principle? I argue below that Utpaladeva's use of the *satkāryavāda* so as to prove the agency of consciousness has been partly misunderstood so far. The reason for this misunderstanding is that neither the verses in which his reasoning is expounded—namely, *Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikā* 2.4.3–4—nor Utpaladeva's short commentary (*Vṛtti*) on them explicitly mention a step in this argument without which its conclusion seems arbitrary. Abhinavagupta's two commentaries mention this crucial step, which involves the Sāṃkhya notion of manifestation (*abhivyakti*), but they only do so in a very elliptical way, most probably because the point was explained in Utpaladeva's now lost detailed commentary (*Vivṛti*) on these verses, and perhaps also because it was already discussed at length by Utpaladeva's predecessor, Somānanda, in the fourth chapter of his *Śivadṛṣṭi*. The following pages are an attempt to gain a fuller picture of Utpaladeva's interpretation of the *satkāryavāda* by examining Abhinavagupta's commentaries, which, in the absence of Utpaladeva's own *Vivṛti*, constitute a particularly precious source of information as regards Utpaladeva's philosophical strategies in the Pratyabhijñā treatise.

The First Principle in Verse 2.4.3: The Nonexistent Cannot Acquire Existence

Utpaladeva's verse 2.4.3 does not explicitly mention the principle of *satkāryavāda*; nonetheless, Abhinavagupta's commentaries make it abundantly clear that this is

[7] See Watson (2006, pp. 90–91).

[8] See e.g. Abhinavagupta's summaries of Chap. II.4 (note that verses 2–4 deal with the *satkāryavāda*). While introducing the chapter in ĪPV, vol. II, p. 135, Abhinavagupta thus explains: *tatra ślokena svamate kartṛkarmabhāva eva kāryakāraṇabhāva ity upakṣipyate. tataḥ ślokatrayeṇa jaḍasya kāraṇatvaṃ parākriyate.* "With the [first] verse of this [new chapter, Utpaladeva] alludes to the fact [— justified by the rest of the chapter —] that in our system, the relation of cause and effect is nothing but the relation between the agent and the object of action. Then in the three [following] verses[, i.e. vv. 2–4, Utpaladeva] refutes [the contention that] causality belongs to the insentient." Cf. ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 184: *tatra kartṛkarmataiva tattvaṃ kāryakāraṇatāyā iti svamate ślokenopakṣipya trayeṇa jaḍasya kāraṇatā nirākriyate.* "In this [new chapter], after alluding in one verse [i.e. v. 1] to the fact [— justified in the rest of the chapter —] that in our system, the real nature (*tattva*) of the relation of cause and effect is nothing but the relation between the agent and the object of action, [Utpaladeva] refutes in three [verses, i.e. vv. 2–4, the contention that] causality belongs to the insentient."

precisely what is at stake here. In the previous verse, Utpaladeva has asserted that insentient entities do not have the power (*śakti*) to bring about the existence of an effect,[9] and according to Abhinavagupta, the new verse explains why this is so.[10] The first part of the verse runs as follows:

> That which is nonexistent is nonexistent: having an existing nature is not rationally possible (*yukta*) for [something] nonexistent.[11]

The verse appears to be reminiscent of the thesis held by the followers of Vārṣagaṇya (/Vr̥ṣagaṇa),[12] who is believed to have written an important Sāṃkhya treatise, the now lost *Ṣaṣṭitantra*,[13] and to whom the *Yogācārabhūmi* ascribes the authorship of the *satkāryavāda*.[14] Thus the *Abhidharmakośabhāṣya* refers to his doctrine in the following way:

[9] ĪPK 2.4.2: *jaḍasya tu na sā śaktiḥ sattā yad asataḥ sataḥ / kartr̥karmatvatattvaiva kāryakāraṇatā tataḥ //* "But the insentient does not possess the power (*śakti*) thanks to which (*yat*) [an effect, whether] nonexistent (*asat*) [or] existing (*sat*) [before the operation of its cause,] could acquire existence. Therefore the relation of cause and effect has as its sole reality the relation between the agent and the object of action." On the various meanings of *asataḥ sataḥ* according to Abhinavagupta, see Torella (2002, p. 175, fn. 3); the present translation follows Abhinavagupta's first interpretation (ĪPV, vol. II, p. 137): *jaḍasya bījasyaivaṃbhūtaṃ sāmarthyaṃ nāsti yad asadrūpaṃ sadrūpaṃ vāṅkuraṃ paridr̥śyamānasattāvantaṃ karoti.* "The insentient seed does not have a power such that it would endow the sprout—whether its nature [already] exists or not—with the existence that [we] perceive [when the sprout has arisen]." Bhāskarakaṇṭha explains that the alternative refers to the *sat-/asatkārya* debate. See *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, pp. 153–154: *sadrūpam iti sāṃkhyamatāpekṣayā, teṣāṃ mate hi sat kāryam, asadrūpam iti tārkika-matāpekṣayā.* "[Abhinavagupta says 'whether] its nature [already] exists' with respect to the Sāṃkhya doctrine; for in their doctrine, the effect exists [before the operation of its cause; and he says 'or whether] its nature is nonexistent' with respect to the doctrine of the [Naiyāyika/Vaiśeṣika] logicians."

[10] See his introduction to the verse in ĪPV, vol. II, p. 137: *nanu jaḍasya katham eṣā śaktir na bhavatīty āha.* "[In the next verse, Utpaladeva] answers [the following question:] 'But how is it that this power does not belong to the insentient?'." Cf. ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 186: *nanu bījād udbhavaty aṅkure cetanānupraveśo naivāstīti cidrūpa eva viśvāvabhāsaka iti kim etat? atrottaraṃ sūtreṇa.* "With the [next] verse, [Utpaladeva provides] the answer to the [following question:] 'But given that in the case of a sprout arising from a seed, there is absolutely no intervention of a conscious [entity], what can [Utpaladeva's claim—namely,] that only that which consists in consciousness manifests the universe—mean?'."

[11] ĪPK 2.4.3ab: *yad asat tad asad yuktā nāsataḥ satsvarūpatā /*

[12] On the name of this author see e.g. Chakravarti (1951, pp. 135–142) and Oberhammer (1960, fn. 1, p. 71).

[13] On this authorship see Oberhammer (1960); for a partial reconstruction of the treatise, see Frauwallner (1958).

[14] See YBh, pp. 118–119: *hetuphalasadvādaḥ katamaḥ. yathāpīhaikatyaḥ śramaṇo vā*[1] *brāhmaṇo vaivaṃdr̥ṣṭir bhavaty evaṃvādī nityaṃ nityakālaṃ dhruvaṃ dhruvakālaṃ vidyata eva hetau phalam iti tadyathā vārṣagaṇyaḥ.*[2] [[1]*śramaṇo vā* em. Wezler (1985, p. 4): *śramaṇo* YBh. [2]*vārṣagaṇyaḥ* YBh: *varṣagaṇyaḥ* ms reading (YBh, p. 119, fn. 2), Seyfort Ruegg (1962–1963, p. 138).] "As to the nature of the doctrine according to which the effect exists in the cause, a certain Śramaṇa or Brāhmaṇa holds this opinion saying that the effect in fact exists in the cause perpetually through perpetual time and constantly through constant time; such a one is Vārṣagaṇya." (Translation Seyfort Ruegg 1962–1963, p. 138). See also Liebenthal (1934, pp. 43ff. and 150), Wezler (1985) and Franco (1991, p. 127).

> And the thesis of Vārṣagaṇya is explained thus: "that which exists *exists*; that which does not exist *does not exist*; there is no arising of what is nonexistent; there is no destruction of what exists."[15]

In his commentaries, Abhinavagupta immediately explains that the principle formulated by Utpaladeva—namely, that what is nonexistent is nonexistent and cannot, therefore, become an existing entity—is the very foundation of the *satkāryavāda*:

> An effect can be assumed [to be] either existing or nonexistent [before the operation of its cause]. As for [this thesis:] "[the effect] is both [existing and nonexistent], neither [existing and nonexistent], inexplicable (*anirvācya*)",[16] it is contradicted by its own formulation, so what is the point [of considering it]? [Now,] if the pot is nonexistent [before the operation of its cause], then, since this [pot]'s ultimate reality is nothing but its having a nonexistent nature, how could it obtain [through the operation of the cause] an existence that is contradictory with its nature? For even innumerable prostrations at its feet cannot make the blue accommodate yellowness![17]

His explanation in the ĪPVV is almost identical:

> An effect can be assumed [to be] either existing or nonexistent [before the operation of its cause]. As for this [thesis]: [the effect] is both [existing and nonexistent, neither [existing or nonexistent], inexplicable (*anirvācya*), it is contradicted by its own formulation. [Now,] among the [two remaining possibilities], if the nature of the pot is nonexistence, then how could it accept an existence that is contradictory with its own nature? Similarly (*iva*), even prosternations at its feet or favours from a king cannot make the blue [accept] to be yellow![18]

Abhinavagupta thus begins his two commentaries by enumerating the positions that can be adopted regarding the ontological status of an effect before it is brought about by its cause: the effect can be considered either as existing or as nonexistent. The Śaiva eliminates from the start, on the grounds that it is self-contradictory, a third thesis, namely, that the effect is both and neither existing and nonexistent, or

[15] AKBh, p. 301: *vārṣagaṇyavādaś caivaṃ dyotito bhavati. yad asty asty eva tat. yan nāsti nāsty eva tat. asato nāsti saṃbhavaḥ. sato nāsti vināśa iti.* For the hypothesis that this "peculiar Sāṃkhya concept of being" of Vārṣagaṇya's followers arose from "*śruti* passages" such as *Chāndogyopaniṣad* 6.2.1, see Wezler (1987, pp. 178–180). For other occurrences of the fragment see Chakravarti (1951, p. 140).

[16] Following Bhāskarakaṇṭha's interpretation (see below, fn. 19), I assume that here (as in the ĪPVV parallel passage below) Abhinavagupta has in mind one single thesis rather than three, but of course I could be wrong (Eli Franco considers that the hypothesis of several theses is more likely).

[17] ĪPV, vol. II, pp. 138–139: *sad vā kāryam asad vā saṃbhāvyate. ubhayātmakam anubhayātmakam anirvācyam iti tu svavācaiva virudhyate tat kim anena? yady asan ghaṭas tarhi tasyāsadrūpataiva paramārtha*[1] *iti kathaṃ svarūpaviruddhaṃ sattvam abhyupagacchet? na hi pādapatanaśatair api nīlam ātmani pītimānaṃ mṛgyate.* [[1]*paramārtha* J, L, S1, S2, *Bhāskarī*: *paramārthata* SOAS, ĪPV.]

[18] ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 187: *sad vāsad vā kāryaṃ sambhāvyate. dvyātmakam, anubhayarūpam anivācyam iti tu svavācaiva virudhyate. tatra yady asattā ghaṭasya rūpaṃ tarhi svarūpaviruddhāṃ sattāṃ kathaṅkāram aṅgīkurutāṃ pādapatanair api rājoparodhair api vā nīlam iva pītatām.*

inexplicable (*anirvācya*). Bhāskarakaṇṭha considers that this third position is that of the (Advaita-)vedānta,[19] and indeed, it is quite probable that here Abhinavagupta has in mind the thesis that the phenomenal world, since it is the product (i.e. the effect) of a metaphysical ignorance (*avidyā*) that is inexplicable in terms of existence or inexistence, is itself inexplicable.[20] He then turns to the second option and shows that the effect cannot be nonexistent before the operation of the cause, because what is nonexistent has a nonexistent nature, so that bringing about the existence of such a thing would amount to destroying its nature: there can be no such thing as the production of a nonexistent entity.

The argument used here is obviously the first reason adduced in *Sāṃkhyakārikā* 9 in favour of the *satkāryavāda*, namely, "because there is no production of the nonexistent" (*asadakaraṇāt*),[21] and Abhinavagupta's preliminary formulation of the possible theses regarding the ontological status of the effect is reminiscent of the way the commentaries on this *Sāṃkhyakārikā* introduce it. Admittedly, these commentaries vary greatly as regards the number of theses involved in the debate and the authorship of these theses: thus the *Gauḍapādabhāṣya* merely opposes the Sāṃkhya contention that the effect exists before the operation of its cause to that of the "Buddhists, etc." who consider the effect as nonexistent,[22] whereas the *Māṭharavṛtti* explains that according to the Vaiśeṣikas, the effect is nonexistent, and attributes to the Ājīvikas (?) the thesis that the effect is both existing and nonexistent, and to the Buddhists, the thesis that it is neither[23]; the *Jayamaṅgalā*

[19] *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 154: *nanu vedāntibhir ubhayātmakatve'py anubhayātmakatārūpam anirvācyatvam atra saṃbhāvyata ity ata āhobhayātmakam iti. "*[Abhinavagupta] says *ubhayātmakam*… because of this [possible objection]: 'But the Vedāntins assume in this [regard] that although [the effect] is both [existing and nonexistent,] its nature consists in being neither [existing or nonexistent], inexplicable."

[20] On Abhinavagupta's criticism of the Vedāntins' view that the phenomenal world and its cause, *avidyā*, are inexplicable, see e.g. Ratié (2011a, p. 566, fn. 211, p. 657 and pp. 669–680).

[21] SK 9: *asadakaraṇād upādānagrahaṇāt sarvasambhavābhāvāt / śaktasya śakyakaraṇāt kāraṇabhāvāc ca sat kāryam //* "Because there is no production of the nonexistent; because one grasps a material cause [adapted to the effect one wishes to produce]; because [a particular thing] cannot arise from everything; because [a cause] capable [of producing a particular effect] produces [only] what it can [produce]; and because [the effect] has as its nature the cause, the effect exists [before the operation of its cause]." Note that Abhinavagupta quotes the beginning of the *kārikā* in another context (see ĪPVV, vol. I, p. 171).

[22] GBh, p. 9: *yad idaṃ mahadādi kāryaṃ tat kiṃ pradhāne sad utāhosvid asat, ācāryavipratipatter ayaṃ saṃśayaḥ, yato'tra sāṃkhyadarśane sat kāryam, bauddhādīnām asat kāryam. yadi sad asan na bhavati, athāsat san na bhavatīti vipratiṣedhas tatrāha*. "Is the effect that [consists of the evolutes of matter, i.e.] the Great, etc., [already] existing in matter, or is it nonexistent? This doubt comes from the disagreement (*vipratipatti*) between masters, since in this Sāṃkhya system, the effect exists, [whereas] for the Bauddhas and so on, the effect is nonexistent. With respect to these conflicting [theories] (*vipratiṣedha*): 'if it exists, it is not nonexistent, but if it is nonexistent, it does not exist,' [the author of the SK] states [the following verse]."

[23] MV, p. 12: *tiṣṭhatu tāvad etat. anyat pṛcchāmaḥ: kim etan mahadādi prāg utpatteḥ pradhāne saj jāyata utāsat sambhavati. atrācāryāṇāṃ vipratipattir ataḥ saṃśayaḥ. atra vaiśeṣikā vipratipannā asataḥ sad bhavatīti manyante. mṛtpiṇḍe hi prāg utpatter ghaṭo nāstīti vyavasitās te. asti nāstīti varākā jīvakāḥ. naivāsti na ca nāsty eṣa bauddhānāṃ pakṣaḥ. evam anyonyavirodhavādiṣu darśiṣu ko nāma niścayaḥ.* "Let us admit what [has been said] so far. [But] we [now] ask something else: do [the evolutes that are] the Great, etc., arise [while they already] exist in matter before [their] arising, or are they nonexistent [at that time]? In this respect, there is a disagreement (*vipratipatti*) among masters, therefore there is a doubt. [Thus] the Vaiśeṣikas, who are of a wrong opinion (*vipratipanna*) in this respect, consider that that which exists comes from that which does not exist. For they consider that in the lump of clay, before the arising

mentions the theses that the effect exists, that it is nonexistent, and that it is both, and contents itself with attributing the second to the Vaiśeṣikas[24]; the *Yuktidīpikā* mentions the thesis that before its arising the effect is nonexistent (and ascribes it to the Vaiśeṣikas and Naiyāyikas), the thesis that the effect is both existing and nonexistent (and ascribes it to the Buddhists) and the thesis that it is neither (without any explicit attribution)[25]; the *Tattvakaumudī* mentions the thesis that the effect comes to exist from a nonexistent cause, the thesis (obviously, that of the Vedāntins) that the effect is only an illusory manifestation (*vivarta*) and therefore no existing entity, the thesis (ascribed to the Naiyāyikas and Vaiśeṣikas) that the nonexistent effect arises from an existing cause, and the Sāṃkhya thesis.[26]

But in spite of their divergences, almost all these Sāṃkhya commentaries introduce the verse in the same way, i.e. by insisting that there is a disagreement (*vipratipatti*) among various masters on the subject,[27] so that the list of reasons adduced to prove the *satkāryavāda* is necessary so as to get rid of the doubt

Footnote 23 continued
[of the pot], there is no pot. The wretched Ājīvikas[?] (*jīvaka*) [consider] that [the effect] is [both] existing and nonexistent. And the thesis of the Buddhists is that [the effect] is neither existing nor nonexistent. Thus, since those teachers hold theses contradicting each other, what certainty [could we get]?" Note should be made that in a previous version of this article (quoted in Bronkhorst 2013, pp. 3 ff.) I had adopted the conjecture *ājīvikāḥ* for *jīvakāḥ* offered by Alexis Sanderson and Vincent Eltschinger (personal communications). However, the term *jīvaka* seems to have been used (in South India at least) to designate the Ājīvikas: see Basham (1951, pp. 182–184) and Bronkhorst (2013, pp. 6–7).

[24] JM, p. 73: *tat kāryaṃ kāraṇād utpadyamānaṃ sad utpadyate, kim asat kiṃ vā sadasad iti? tatra viruddhadharmādhyāsitatvāt sadasan nopapadyate. asad iti vaiśeṣikāḥ. atra dūṣaṇam āha*. "Does this effect which arises from a cause exist while arising, or is it nonexistent, or again, is it [both] existing and nonexistent? In this regard, because [existence and nonexistence] possess contradictory properties, [the effect] cannot be [both] existing and nonexistent. The Vaiśeṣikas [consider that it is] nonexistent. In order to refute this [the author] states [the following verse]."

[25] YD, p. 109 (answering the objection that there is no point in considering a doubt as regards the existence of the effect, as there is no room for such a doubt): *ucyate: asti saṃśayāvakāśaḥ. kasmāt. ācāryavipratipatteḥ. prāg utpatteḥ kāryam asad ity ācāryāḥ kaṇādākṣapādaprabhṛtayo manyante. sad asad iti bauddhāḥ. naiva san nāsad ity anye. tasmād upapannaḥ saṃśayaḥ.* "[To this objection we] answer [the following]: there is indeed room for [such a] doubt, because of the disagreement among masters (*ācāryavipratipatti*). [To explain:] masters such as Kaṇāda and Akṣapāda consider that before its arising, the effect is nonexistent; the Buddhists [consider] that [the effect] is [both] existing and nonexistent; others [consider] that it is neither existing nor nonexistent. Therefore doubt is possible [in this regard]."

[26] TK, p. 94: *kāryāt kāraṇamātraṃ gamyate. santi cātra vādināṃ vipratipattayaḥ. kecid āhur asataḥ saj jayata iti. ekasya sato vivartaḥ kāryajātaṃ na vastu sad ity apare. anye tu sato'saj jāyata iti. sataḥ saj jāyata iti vṛddhāḥ.* "From [the existence of] an effect [we only] know [that there is] a cause in general[, but we do not know what its nature is]. And in this respect there are disagreements (*vipratipatti*) between the proponents [of various systems]. Some say that [the effect] comes to exist from [a cause] that is nonexistent. Others [say] that all effects are an illusory manifestation (*vivarta*) of the one existing [entity, but that they] are no real, existing entity. Others again [say] that from an existing [cause] arises a nonexistent [effect]. As for the Sages (*vṛddha*), [they say] that an existing [effect] arises from an existing [cause]." Several manuscript marginal annotations ascribe the first thesis to the Buddhists (*bauddhāḥ*), the second, to the Vedāntins, the third, to the Naiyāyikas, and the fourth, to the Sāṃkhyas (see n. 6, 10, 11 and 13, p. 95). The TK later explicitly ascribes the third thesis to the Vaiśeṣikas and Naiyāyikas (see p. 96: *yeṣām api kaṇabhakṣākṣacaraṇādīnāṃ sata eva kāraṇād asato janma…*).

[27] The word *vipratipatti* appears in the GBh, MV, YD and TK (see above, fn. 22, 23, 25 and 26).

(*saṃśaya*) bound to arise due to the multiplicity of contradictory theses held in this regard—and Abhinavagupta seems to mimic this Sāṃkhya tradition.[28] His dismissal of the thesis that the effect is inexplicable, i.e., both and neither existent and nonexistent, is quite close to that found in the *Māṭharavṛtti*,[29] but most importantly, his sarcastic example of the blue refusing to become yellow irresistibly brings to mind Vācaspatimiśra's explanation of the first reason in favour of the *satkāryavāda* in the *Tattvakaumudī*:

> [The author of the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*-s] states the reason why [the effect must exist before the operation of its cause by saying] "because there is no production of the nonexistent". [That is to say:] if the effect is nonexistent before the operation of its cause, its existence cannot be produced; for even innumerable artists cannot make the blue yellow![30]

The Second Principle in Verse 2.4.3: The Existent Does Not Need to Acquire Existence

So up to this point, according to Abhinavagupta, Utpaladeva has simply stated the reason that legitimates the Sāṃkhyas' *satkāryavāda*: the effect must exist before the

[28] Cf. the manner in which the Sāṃkhya opponent portrayed by Jayanta Bhaṭṭa introduces his thesis in NM (M), vol. II, p. 398/NM (V), vol. II, p. 292: *nanu satkāryavāde kāryakāraṇabhāvo bhavati bhāvānāṃ nānyathā. tathā hi catuṣṭayo gatir iha syāt. ghaṭādikāryaṃ mṛtpiṇḍādinā kāraṇena yat kriyamāṇam asad vā kriyate sad vā*[1] *sadasad vānubhayaṃ*[2] *veti.* [[1]*kāraṇena yat kriyamāṇam asad vā kriyate sad vā* conj.: NM(M): *kāryayena kriyamāṇam asad vā kriyate sad vā* NM(M); *kāraṇena kriyamāṇam api kriyate sadvāsadvā* NM(V). [2]*vānubhayaṃ* NM (V): *vānubhayasvabhāvaṃ* NM(M).]"[—Objection:] But there can be a relation of cause and effect between entities if [one admits] the *satkāryavāda* and not otherwise. To explain—there are four ways of understanding this [relation of cause and effect]: the effect such as the pot which is being produced by a cause such as the lump of clay is produced [while being] nonexistent, or [while already] existing, [while being both] existing and nonexistent, or [while being] neither [existing] nor [existent]." It should also be noted that Abhinavagupta, who mentions three theses (that the effect is existent, nonexistent, and both or neither) and immediately rejects the third on the grounds that it is self-contradictory, might also be alluding to NS 4.1.48 (which both the NBh and the NV interpret as a thesis to be refuted by showing that in fact the effect is nonexistent before the cause's operation): NS 4.1.48. *nāsan na san na sadasat sadasator vaidharmyāt*. "[Before its arising (*niṣpatti*), the result (*phala*)] is not nonexistent, nor is it [already] existing, nor is it [both] existing and nonexistent, because of the contradiction between the properties (*vaidharmya*) of existence and nonexistence."

[29] See MV, p. 12: *tatra tāvat sadasadvādina jīvakāḥ svavacanavirodhenaiva nirastāḥ. yadi sat tadāsan na bhavati. utāsat tadā sadbhāvo na. yataḥ sadasator ekatra virodhāt. atra dṛṣṭānto yathā devadatto mṛto jīvati cetivat.* "In this regard, to begin with, the Ājīvikas[?] (*jīvaka*), who are proponents of the thesis that [the effect] is both existing and nonexistent, are defeated by the contradiction in their own speech: if [the effect] is existing, then it is not nonexistent; or again, if it is nonexistent, then it has no existence, since existence and nonexistence are contradictory in one [and the same thing]. The example in this regard is as follows: Devadatta is dead and [yet] he lives." On the term *jīvaka* see above, fn. 23.

[30] TK, pp. 96–98: *atra hetum āha: asadakaraṇāt. asac cet kāraṇavyāpārāt pūrvaṃ kāryaṃ nāsya sattvaṃ kartuṃ śakyam. na hi nīlaṃ śilpisahasreṇāpi pītaṃ kartuṃ śakyate.* If the dates proposed for Vācaspatimiśra (i.e. c. 950–1000) in Acharya (2006, pp. xviii–xxviii) are right, Abhinavagupta (and even perhaps Utpaladeva) may have known the TK. For other similarities between Abhinavagupta's presentation of Sāṃkhya doctrines and the TK, see Ratié (2011a, pp. 97–101); on the proximity of some passages in Utpaladeva's ĪS with Vācaspatimiśra's argument for the existence of *īśvara*, see Krasser (2002, fn. 211, p. 152).

operation of its cause, because according to the first reason adduced in *Sāṃkhyakārikā* 9, there can be no production of what is nonexistent, since such a production would be contradictory with its nonexistent nature. But in his verse, Utpaladeva adds:

> Then again, for an [already] existing [entity], there is no point in acquiring existence.[31]

Abhinavagupta comments:

> If, on the other hand, the pot exists [before the operation of its cause], then what else could [still] be asked from the [potter's] stick, wheel and thread [that are supposed to cause the pot's existence]?[32]

If the pot is nonexistent before the operation of its cause, as a non-entity it cannot be brought to existence; but if it is already existent, the cause becomes useless and causality remains just as impossible to comprehend, since an effect that already exists does not need to acquire existence. The reasoning, which is already found in Nāgārjuna's *Mūlamadhyamakakārikā*-s,[33] seems to have been used early on by Buddhist authors targetting the Sāṃkhya theory of causation,[34] and it is presented by Śāntarakṣita and Kamalaśīla as the counter-argument against the first reason stated in *Sāṃkhyakārikā* 9: while the Sāṃkhyas claim that the effect must exist before the operation of the cause "because there is no production of the nonexistent" (*asadakaraṇāt*), the Buddhists argue that the *satkāryavāda* is wrong "because there is no production of what [already] exists" (*sadakaraṇāt*)—and if the cause does not produce the effect, it is no cause at all.[35] A Brahmanical author such as the

[31] ĪPK 2.4.3c: *sato'pi na punaḥ sattālābhenārthaḥ… //*

[32] ĪPV, vol. II, p. 139: *atha sann eva ghaṭas tarhi kim anyad upayācyate daṇḍacakrasūtrāt.* Cf ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 187: *athāsya sattātmakaṃ rūpaṃ tad ayaṃ kim upayācatāṃ daṇḍādibhyaḥ.* "If, on the other hand, the nature of the [pot] is to exist, then what could it [still] ask from the [potter's] stick and so on?"

[33] MMK 1.6: *naivāsato naiva sataḥ pratyayo'rthasya yujyate / asataḥ pratyayaḥ kasya sataś ca pratyayena kim //* "A cause is possible neither for a nonexistent thing nor for an existing [one]; what nonexistent [thing] could have a cause? And what would be the point of the cause of an existing [thing]?" See e.g. Bronkhorst (2011, p. 40).

[34] On its use by Āryadeva see Honda (1974, p. 489). Regarding later authors see e.g. Bhavya/Bhāviveka's MHK 144ab: *saty ātmani ca bhāvasya vṛthā kāraṇakalpanā /* "And if the nature of an entity [already] exists, it is useless to postulate a cause." The principle also appears in Dharmapāla's commentary on the *Catuḥśataka*: see Tillemans (1990, vol. I, p. 162) ("if the effect's nature already existed, then why would it again need a cause?") and ibid., p. 266, n. 323, on this "widely used argument against the idea of the effect existing at the time of the cause".

[35] See TS 17: *yadi dadhyādayaḥ santi dugdhādyātmasu sarvathā / teṣāṃ satāṃ kim utpādyaṃ hetvādisadṛśātmanām //* "If the curd and so on are [already] entirely (*sarvathā*) existing in the natures of milk and so on, what [nature] could [the causes] bring about for them, [since the curd and so on already] exist [and] have a nature identical to their cause and so on?" TSP, p. 25 explains that "this [argument] is meant as a demonstration of [the validity of] the [following reason against the Sāṃkhya thesis:] 'because there is no production of what [already] exists'" (*sadakaraṇād ity etatsamarthanārtham idam*). TS 18 develops the argument: *hetujanyaṃ na tat kāryaṃ sattāto hetuvittivat / ato nābhimato hetur asādhyatvāt parātmavat //* "The effect cannot be produced by the cause, because [it already] exists, just as the cause [i.e. matter] and consciousness[, which you assume to be both eternally existing and therefore unproduced]. So [the thing that you] assume [to be a cause] is not a cause, because [it] has nothing to accomplish, just as that other nature [that you assume not to be a cause, i.e. the conscious principle]."

Naiyāyika Uddyotakara puts forward a somewhat similar argument: if the effect already exists, then there is no more point in engaging in any kind of action[36]; the potter has recourse to a material cause such as clay because he wants to produce a pot, but if the pot already exists, the cause and, more generally speaking, the action, are bound to be useless.[37]

The Classical Sāṃkhya Solution to this Problem: The *Abhivyakti* Theory

The Sāṃkhyas, however, have given an answer to the problem just raised by Utpaladeva. Thus the *Yuktidīpikā*, relying on Vārṣagaṇya's assertion that the universe appears and disappears without coming into being or being altogether destroyed, explains that although the effect is not made to exist by the cause—since it already exists in the cause in a latent form or as a potentiality (*śakti*) —, it is revealed or made manifest by the cause; and just as it is not really produced but merely manifested by the cause, in the same way, it does not really suffer destruction but only ceases to be manifested.[38] The effect is thus the result of a process of transformation (*pariṇāma*) explained in terms of mere appearance (*āvirbhāva*) and disappearance (*tirobhāva*) and not in terms of arising and

[36] See NV, p. 458 (commenting on NS 4.1.49: *utpādavyayadarśanāt.* "[The effect does not exist before its arising] because [we] observe [its] arising and destruction"): *na hi satpakṣa utpādo na ca vināśa iti. utpādavināśau ca pratyācakṣāṇena loko heyaḥ. atha loko'yaṃ pravartamānaḥ kimarthaṃ pravartate? nanu cāyaṃ pravartata idam āpsyāmīdaṃ hāsyāmīti. satyam evaṃ pravartate. na punaḥ satkāryavādinaḥ kiñcid dheyam upādeyaṃ vā vidyate.* "For according to the view that [the effect already] exists, there is neither any arising nor any destruction [of the effect]; and he who denies arising as well as destruction must abandon [the world of] ordinary people (*loka*). Now, these ordinary people engaged in action, for what purpose do they engage in action?—Surely, they engage in action [thinking:] 'I want to obtain this, I want to get rid of this'?—True, they engage in action in this way. But for the proponent of the *satkāryavāda*, there is nothing to get rid of (*heya*) or to have recourse to (*upādeya*)."

[37] NV, p. 458: *na hi yad yasya loke bhavati, sa tadartham upādānam upādatta iti.* "For in the world, [someone] who [already] possesses a [thing] does not have recourse to a material cause in order to [bring about] this [thing]."

[38] See e.g. YD, pp. 128–129: *kāraṇānāṃ tu yaḥ parasparasaṃsargāt saṃsthānaviśeṣaparigrahaḥ, tasya virodhiśaktyantarāvirbhāvād vyaktis tirodhīyata ity etad vināśaśabdena vivakṣitam. tathā ca vārṣagaṇāḥ paṭhanti – tad etat trailokyaṃ vyakter apaiti na sattvāt. apetam apy asti vināśapratiṣedhāt. saṃsargāc cāsya saukṣmyaṃ saukṣmyāc cānupalabdhiḥ. tasmād vyaktyapagamo vināśaḥ.* "Rather, the manifestation (*vyakti*) of the [effect], which has assumed a particular arrangement through the merging of [its] causes into one another, disappears due to the manifestation of another potentiality (*śakti*) that contradicts [the first one]—this is what the word 'destruction' [really] means. And accordingly, the followers of Vṛṣagaṇa teach [the following]: 'All this threefold world withdraws from manifestation, [but] not from existence. [And] even though it withdraws [from manifestation], it exists, because [we] deny [the possibility of] destruction. And because of its merging [into primordial nature, the world] is subtle; and due to its subtlety, it is not perceived. Therefore destruction is the disappearance of manifestation." On this famous passage see e.g. Chakravarti (1951, pp. 139–140), Frauwallner (1953, p. 352), Wezler (1987, pp. 176–177), Halbfass (1992, p. 59), and Watanabe (2011, p. 558). On this notion of *abhivyakti* in the Sāṃkhya argument for *satkāryavāda*, see Muroya (1996) (which, unfortunately, I was not able to consult as I do not read Japanese).

annihilation.[39] What the cause produces is not the existence (*sattva*) of the effect, but only its manifestation (*abhivyakti*, *vyakti*), and the *Tattvakaumudī* points out that this is the case precisely because the effect already exists before its so-called production[40]: the *abhivyakti* theory (which seems to date back at least to Vārṣagaṇya, just as the *satkāryavāda*)[41] answers the objection that a cause is useless if the effect already exists, since the cause is required for the manifestation of the effect[42]; and yet the cause does not affect in any way the very existence of the

[39] YD, p. 163: *yadā śaktyantarānugrahāt pūrvadharmaṃ tirobhāvya svarūpād apracyuto dharmī dharmāntareṇāvirbhavati tad avasthānam asmākaṃ pariṇāma ity ucyate.* "We call 'transformation' the state [that occurs] when, after making a previous property disappear (*tirobhāvya*) by assuming another power, the property-bearer, which does not abandon its nature, appears (*āvirbhavati*) with another property." See Watanabe (2011, p. 557).

[40] TK, p. 98: *tasmāt kāraṇavyāpārād ūrdhvam iva prāg api sad eva kāryam iti. karaṇaṃ cāsya sato'bhivyaktir avaśiṣyate.* "Therefore, before the operation of the cause as well as after, the effect can only be existing. And [what] remains [as a possibility regarding] the production of this [effect which already] exists is a [mere] manifestation (*abhivyakti*)."

[41] See YBh, p. 120, following the presentation and refutation of the theory (explicitly ascribed to Vārṣagaṇya by the same text) that the effect preexists in the cause: *abhivyaktivādaḥ katamaḥ. yathāpīhaikatyaḥ śramaṇo vā brāhmaṇo vā evaṃdṛṣṭir bhavaty evaṃvādī. vidyamānā eva bhāvā abhivyajyante notpadyante. tadyathā sa eva hetuphalasadvādī śabdalakṣaṇavādī ca.* "As to the nature of the doctrine according to which [effects are not produced, but only] become manifest (*abhivyaktivāda*), a certain Śramaṇa or Brāhmaṇa holds this opinion saying that things as always existent are manifested [and] do not originate [from their causes], namely the same [man] who teaches the doctrine according to which the effect exists [already] in the cause and [in addition the grammarian] who teaches the doctrine that [this, i.e. becoming manifest] is characteristic of the nature of words [when uttered]." (Translation Wezler 1985, p. 10.)

[42] The YBh thus explains that this is the reason why the proponent of the theory that the effect preexists in its cause adopts the *abhivyaktivāda.* See YBh, p. 120: *tasyaivaṃ bhavati. na hi hetoḥ*[1] *phalasya vidyamānasyotpattir yujyate. na ca na kriyate prayatnaḥ phalaniṣpattaye. tac ca kiṃnimittaṃ kriyata iti. yāvad evābhivyaktyartha iti. sa evaṃ parikalpyābhivyaktivādī bhavati.* [[1]*hetoḥ* em. Wezler (1985, p. 10): *hetau* Ybh.] "He gets the following idea: the effect can clearly not originate from the cause inasmuch as it exists [already] in the cause; [on the other hand] it is not the case that no effort is made in order to 'produce' the effect. Thus [one has to ask oneself] for what reason [this effort] is made. [The answer can only be that it is made] for the sole purpose of the manifestation [of the already existing effect]. Insofar as he imagines in this manner, [the *hetuphalasadvādin*] is [at the same time] an upholder of the doctrine of manifestation." (Translation Wezler 1985, p. 10.) Similarly, faced with the objection stated in TS 17–18 (see above, fn. 35), the Sāṃkhya opponent portrayed by Śāntarakṣita replies in TS 19 by having recourse to this notion of manifestation: *athāsty atiśayaḥ kaścid abhivyaktyādilakṣaṇaḥ / yaṃ hetavaḥ prakurvāṇā na yānti vacanīyatām //* "But there is indeed some additional feature (*atiśaya*) [in the effect after the causal operation,] which is characterized as a manifestation (*abhivyakti*) and so on; [and] since they produce this [additional feature,] the causes are not laid open to [your] criticism." See also the thesis of the Sāṃkhya opponent portrayed by Jayanta Bhaṭṭa in NM (M), vol. II, p. 400/ NM (V), vol. II, p. 293: *kimiti ca tadā nopalabhyata iti cet,*[1] *anumānenāpi yad upalabdhaṃ tat kim anupalabdham bhavati? pratyakṣeṇa tu tadānīm*[2] *anupalambho'nabhivyaktatvāt. abhivyaktisampādana*[3] *eva ca kārakaprayatnasāphalyam, kāryaṃ tu sad eveti.* [[1]*iti cet* NM (M): *iti* NM(V). [2]*tadānīm* NM(V): *tadanīm* NM(M). [3]*abhivyaktisampādana* NM(V): *abhivyatisampādana* NM(M).] "And if [one asks] why [the effect, although existing,] is not apprehended then, [i.e. before the operation of its cause, we answer:] what about that which is apprehended through inference—is it not apprehended [at all]? Rather, [it] is not apprehended through perception at that time because it is not manifested (*anabhivyakta*); and the effort of the factors of action (*kāraka*) brings about a result (*sāphalya*) precisely insofar as it provides this manifestation, but the effect necessarily exists [before the operation of the cause]."

effect.[43] It is worth noting that this solution to the problem of causality appealed to the Śaiva dualists and is found for instance in the *Mṛgendratantra.*[44]

Utpaladeva's Idealistic Definition of the Relation of Cause and Effect in Verses 2.4.3–4

However, Utpaladeva's verses make no mention of this notion of *abhivyakti* that the Sāṃkhya presents as the solution to the problem of causality. Instead, they merely highlight this problem (an effect that does not exist cannot be made to exist by any cause, but an already existing effect does not need any cause to exist) and add:

> And yet, in the world [we] talk about the relation of cause and effect.[45]

Abhinavagupta explains that by saying so, Utpaladeva is anticipating the reaction of an interlocutor who might consider, in view of the problem just stated, that causality has to remain aporetic and that the only option left is the abandonment of any endeavour to give a rational account of the relation of cause and effect.[46] According to Abhinavagupta, Utpaladeva is pointing out that we cannot content ourselves with burying the problem in silence, because in the ordinary world we do talk about the relation of cause and effect:

> And it is not proper for a philosopher (*prāmāṇika*) to remain silent because of [what we have established] so far; for in the world, this [relation of cause and effect] is not impeded [by the apparent contradiction in this relation], and the

[43] See e.g. TK, pp. 100–102: *yathā kūrmasyāṅgāni kūrmaśarīre niviśamānāni tirobhavanti niḥsaranti cāvirbhavanti, na ca kūrmatas tadaṅgāny utpadyante dhvaṃsante vā, evam ekasyā mṛdaḥ suvarṇād*[1] *vā kuṭakaṭakādayo niḥsaranta āvirbhavanta utpadyanta ity ucyate niviśamānās tirobhavanto naśyantīty ucyate. na punar asatām utpādaḥ satāṃ vā nirodho yathāha bhagavān kṛṣṇadvaipāyano nāsato vidyate bhāvo nābhāvo vidyate sata iti.* [[1]*suvarṇād* conj.: *suvarṇasya* TK.] "Just as the limbs of a tortoise, [when] retracted in the tortoise's body, disappear, and when spreading out, appear, and yet these limbs of the [tortoise] do not arise from the tortoise, nor are they destroyed; in the same way, [we] say of [things] such as a pot or a bracelet that they 'arise' from one [lump of] clay or from gold [when in fact they are merely] spreading out, [i.e.,] becoming manifest, [and we say that they] 'are destroyed' [when they are] retracted, [i.e.] disappearing; but there is no arising of nonexistent [things], or no destruction of existing [things]. As the venerable Kṛṣṇadvaipāyana has said [in *Bhagavadgītā* 2.16]: 'there is no such thing as an existence of the nonexistent or a nonexistence of the existing."

[44] See MT 1.9.20a: *tad vyaktir jananaṃ nāma…*, "What [we usually] call 'production' is a [mere] manifestation (*vyakti*)", and MTṬ ad loc., p. 201: *tad etat paṭāder bhāvasya jananam abhimataṃ yat turītantuvemādisamāśrayāc chaktyātmanāvasthitasya tasyābhivyaktiḥ.* "That which is [usually] regarded as the production of the existence of a cloth for instance is [in fact] the manifestation (*abhivyakti*) of [a cloth that already] exists in the form of a potentiality (*śakti*), [a manifestation that occurs] due to its resting on the shuttle, threads, loom and so on."

[45] ĪPK 2.4.3d–4a: *…atha cocyate // kāryakāraṇatā loke…*

[46] See the introduction to ĪPK 2.4.3d–4a in ĪPV, vol. I, p. 138: *nanv evaṃ tūṣṇīm āsyatām, naitad api yuktam ity āha.* "[Utpaladeva] states [the following passage with the intention of showing] that this [objection] does not hold: 'But [since it is so], let [us] admit that [we] are reduced to silence'."

> usage [of the words 'cause' and 'effect' as well as the behaviour related to them] (*vyavahāra*) is widespread.[47]

Here as often in the Pratyabhijñā treatise, the reasoning rests on the principle that the *vyavahāra*—the world of linguistic usage and the human transactions that are built on it—cannot be denied,[48] and that the philosopher's main task is to account for it. Wordly usage "must necessarily be accounted for" (*avaśyasamarthya*),[49] and this is why, according to Abhinavagupta, by stating that we talk about the relation of cause and effect, Utpaladeva implies that we have no choice but to try and justify it:

> What [Utpaladeva] means [by saying that in the world we talk about the relation of cause and effect] is [this]: "therefore this thing [denoted by the words 'relation of cause and effect'][50] must necessarily be accounted for."[51]

Utpaladeva then provides his own definition of the relation of cause and effect:

> This [relation of cause and effect (*kāryakāraṇatā*)] is the fact that [something] which exists dynamically (*viparivartin*)[52] inside [consciousness] becomes an object of knowledge (*vedya*) for both [external and internal] sense organs (*indriya*) through the power (*śakti*) of this prodigious entity (*tasya kasyāpi*) [that is consciousness].[53]

Utpaladeva's definition of the relation of cause and effect is not quite clear at first sight because it implicitly rests on a number of ideas that he has already discussed at length in his treatise and that constitute the core of the Śaiva nondualistic metaphysics: the universe only appears to be distinct from consciousness, but in fact it is nothing but a single, all-encompassing consciousness appearing to itself *as if it were distinct from consciousness*, just as a dreamer believes that the universe in which (s)he acts exists outside of his consciousness, whereas in fact that universe is nothing but his or her own consciousness taking the form of an external universe. According to Utpaladeva, the causality relation is nothing but this process of apparent externalization (*bahirmukhatva*) through which the universal consciousness manifests itself as if it were external to itself: being an effect is nothing but becoming an object of knowledge for the sense organs, that is to say, it is nothing but the universal consciousness manifesting itself as an object external to a subject, just as when we dream, our consciousness appears as if it were split between the

[47] ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 187: *na ceyatā tūṣṇīm evāsitum ucitaṃ prāmāṇikasya. loke hy apratihateyaṃ prahataś*[1] *ca vyavahāraḥ.* [[1]*apratihateyaṃ prahataś* BL: *apratihatā …. prahataś* ĪPVV.]

[48] See e.g. ĪPV, vol. I, p. 61, where Abhinavagupta says that memory (*smṛti*) cannot be denied (*anapahnavanīya*) "because [we] see that every worldly usage is accomplished through it" (*tayā… sarvo vyavahāraḥ kriyamāṇo dṛṣṭa iti*, see Ratié (2011a, p. 67)).

[49] See e.g. ĪPV, vol. I, pp. 289–291, where Abhinavagupta explains that the relation of contradiction "must necessarily be accounted for" (*avaśyasamarthyo*) because it is "the [very] life of all worldly usages" (*viśveṣāṃ vyavahārāṇāṃ jīvitabhūtaḥ*, see Ratié (2011a, p. 154)).

[50] *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 155: *ayam arthaḥ – kāryakāraṇabhāvākhyo'rthaḥ.*

[51] ĪPV, vol. II, p. 139: *tad avaśyasamarthyo'yam artha iti yāvat.*

[52] On this term see Torella (2002, fn. 4, p. 176).

[53] ĪPK 2.4.4: … *sāntarviparivartinaḥ / ubhayendriyavedyatvaṃ tasya kasyāpi śaktitaḥ //*

dreaming subject on the one hand and a number of objects that we perceive on the other hand. So a pot that has just been created by a potter is an effect insofar as it is the universal consciousness manifesting itself as if it were external to the consciousness of those who see it. And even the representation of an imaginary pot in the potter's mind is an effect insofar as it becomes an object of knowledge for the potter's mind: according to the Śaivas, imagination already involves some kind of externalization insofar as we are capable of grasping an imaginary object as an entity distinct from us (we can think about "the imaginary pot" as opposed to our consciousness taking the form of this pot, and it is because we are capable of thus distinguishing this imaginary entity from ourselves that we talk about this object as an imaginary *creation*). Although an imaginary object is internal insofar as it is only grasped by the internal organ that is the mind (*manas*), it is already external inasmuch as it already appears in the mind as a distinct entity opposed to the consciousness that apprehends it[54]—which is why Utpaladeva defines the effect as an object of knowledge that can be apprehended by both internal and external organs.[55]

What Happened to the Sāṃkhya Notion of *Abhivyakti*?

Utpaladeva's solution to the problem of causality is perfectly coherent with his idealistic system. But what is striking in the verses that he devotes to this problem is that he presents the Śaiva nondualists' idealism as the *only* solution to this problem. Now, as seen above, the Sāṃkhya's solution to the same problem, namely, the thesis that causes produce the manifestation (*abhivyakti*) of the effect, was widely known by the time Utpaladeva wrote his treatise, and even the fiercest opponents of the Sāṃkhya *satkāryavāda* had to take it into account. So what happened to the Sāṃkhya theory of *abhivyakti* in the Pratyabhijñā treatise? Did Utpaladeva simply ignore it? Johannes Bronkhorst's penetrating accounts of Utpaladeva's position,

[54] See ĪPK 1.8.8: *vikalpe yo'yam ullekhaḥ so'pi bāhyaḥ pṛthakprathaḥ / pramātraikātmyam āntaryaṃ tato bhedo hi bāhyatā //* "The [imaginary] representation (*ullekha*) in a conceptual construction (*vikalpa*) is external too [insofar as] its manifestation is separated [from the imagining subject]; for internality is the identity with the subject, [and] externality is what is different from this[, i.e., it consists in being distinguished from the subject]." Cf. ĪPV, vol. I, p. 333: *vimarśaviśeṣarūpe vikalpajñāne ya ullikhyamānaḥ kāntācaurādir arthaḥ so'pi bāhyaḥ, na kevalaṃ bahir avalokyamānaḥ, yasmāt so'pi pramātuḥ sakāśāt pṛthag eva prathate'yam iti, yac ca pramātary aham ity eva viśrāntatvaṃ tad āntaratvam.* "An object such as the beloved, the thief and so on, that [we] are in the process of picturing up (*ullikhyamāna*) in a conceptual cognition consisting in a particular awareness (*vimarśa*) is external too —[that is,] it is not only the object that [we] are seeing outside [of us that is external, but also the imagined object,] because this [imagined object] too is manifest as being separated (*pṛthak*) from the knowing subject, in the form 'this'; and internality is the fact that [something] rests on the subject in the sole form 'I'."

[55] On this paradoxical status of the imaginary object, which Abhinavagupta thus describes as both internal and external, see Ratié (2010b, fn. 13, p. 345). This is also true of internal states that are apprehended by us as objects, such as pleasure. See ĪPV, vol. II, p. 140: *sukhādīnām antaḥkaraṇai-kavedyatāpādanam eva nirmāṇam.* "The creation of pleasure and so on is nothing but the fact that [pleasure and other such internal states] become objects of knowledge for the sole internal organ [and not for the external sense organs]."

which exclusively rest on the verses and *Vṛtti*,[56] might suggest that it is the case: after showing that the effect must exist before the cause acts, Utpaladeva would simply add that under such circumstances, only his idealism can provide a rational justification of the causal process. But why is this so? Why should the Śaiva nondualists' idealism constitute a more satisfactory solution than the Sāṃkhya theory of *abhivyakti*, which involves no such idealism? If we content ourselves with reading the verses and *Vṛtti*, Utpaladeva's conclusion seems devoid of any rational necessity, and his solution to the problem of causality appears to be hardly more than a dogmatic assertion.

The Criticism of the *Abhivyakti* Theory: A Difficult Dilemma (*Vikalpa*)

However, in both of his commentaries, Abhinavagupta alludes to the Sāṃkhya theory of *abhivyakti*. And although he does so in a particularly elliptical way, so that so far this aspect of the problem has not attracted scholarly attention, I would like to argue that this is a key aspect of Utpaladeva's reasoning. Right after explaining how problematic causality is if we consider that the effect must be already existing and nonetheless needs no cause if it already exists, Abhinavagupta thus adds in the *Vimarśinī*:

> As for being the object of a manifestation (*abhivyakti*), becoming vivid[ly perceived] (*sphuṭa*) and so on, one should examine whether their nature exists or is nonexistent.[57]

The *Vivṛtivimarśinī* contains an almost identical statement:

> As for being the object of a manifestation, becoming vivid[ly perceived] and so on, one should question whether they exist or not.[58]

Bhāskarakaṇṭha makes it clear that here Abhinavagupta is replying to the Sāṃkhya contention that although effects preexist the operation of their causes, causes are causes insofar as they do produce something, namely, the manifestation (*abhivyakti*) of the effect:

> [Abhinavagupta] says "[As for being the object of] a manifestation (*abhivyakti*)"[, etc,] as an answer [to this objection]: "But in this regard, the [causes] such as the [potter's] stick produce the manifestation and the [property of] being vivid[ly perceived], etc."[59]

[56] See Bronkhorst (1996, p. 616; 2011, pp. 68–70). The *Vṛtti* ad loc. (p. 55) states: *asataḥ satsvabhāvatā viruddhā sataś ca siddhā. siddhasyaivāntar bāhyāntaḥkaraṇadvayīvedyatāpādanam īśvareṇotpādanam.* "Having an existing nature would be contradictory for [something] nonexistent, and [having an existing nature] is [already] established for [something] that exists. [Therefore] the arising [of an effect through a cause] is [nothing but] the fact that [something] that is already established internally becomes an object of knowledge for both the internal and external [sense] organs thanks to the Lord." See Torella (2002, p. 176).

[57] ĪPV, vol. II, p. 139: *abhivyaktiviṣayatvasphuṭatvādayo'pi sadasadrūpatayā cintyāḥ.*

[58] ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 187: *vyaktiviṣayatvasphuṭatvādayo'pi sadasattayānuyojyāḥ.*

[59] *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 155: *nanv atrābhivyaktiḥ sphuṭatvādi ca daṇḍādibhiḥ sādhyata ity ata āhābhivyaktīti.*

Abhinavagupta is therefore alluding to the Sāṃkhya traditional answer to the objection that a cause cannot produce anything if the effect is considered to be already existing before the causal operation: according to the proponent of the *satkāryavāda*, a cause merely reveals the already existing effect or makes it perceptible. But Abhinavagupta immediately rejects this answer by arguing that this manifestation in turn must be subjected to the same examination that was first applied to the effect. In other words, one must ask whether the manifestation produced by the cause exists before the operation of the cause or not. Abhinavagupta does not state *why* such a dilemma is fatal to the Sāṃkhya thesis, but Bhāskarakaṇṭha's commentary explains it:

> "One should examine" [these manifestation, property of being vividly perceived and so on]—that is to say, if they have an existing nature, then their production is useless, but if they have a nonexistent nature, then their production is plagued by impossibility.[60]

The same reasoning is expounded in a marginal annotation found in the manuscript of Abhinavagupta's *Vimarśinī*:

> As for what [some] say, [namely:] "the pot, which indeed exists [before the operation of its cause,] is manifested through the operation of the cause", [one must object to it:] "But this manifestation, does it exist or is it nonexistent? If it exists, the operation of the cause is useless; [but] if it is nonexistent, [the cause] cannot bring about the existence of a nonexistent [thing], just as [no cause can bring about the existence] of a hare's horn[61]; and one must ask the

[60] *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 155: *cintyā iti, yadi sadrūpās tarhi tatsādhanam aphalam eva, yadi tv asadrūpās tarhi tatsādhanam asaṃbhavopahatam eveti bhāvaḥ.*

[61] The hare's horn is a stock example of nonexistent thing in Indian philosophical literature, and it is used by Sāṃkhya authors to illustrate the first reason for the *satkāryavāda* stated in SK 9, i.e. the idea that what is by nature nonexistent cannot be produced or made to exist. See e.g. JM, p. 74: *asadakaraṇād ityādi. iha loke'sataḥ karaṇaṃ nāsti, yathā śaśaviṣāṇādīnām. yad eva sad ghaṭādidravyaṃ tad eva mṛtpiṇḍādinā kāraṇaviśeṣeṇa kriyate, nāsat.* "Because there is no production of what is nonexistent, etc., [means the following.] In this world, there is no production of [that which is] nonexistent, such as a hare's horn, etc.: it is only that which exists, [i.e.] a substance such as a pot, that is produced through a particular cause, such as a lump of clay, etc., [whereas that which is] nonexistent is not [produced]." Cf. MV, p. 12: *iha loke sad eva sad bhavati. asataḥ karaṇaṃ nāsti. yadi syāt tadā sikatābhyas tailaṃ kūrmaromabhyaḥ paṭaprāvaraṇaṃ vandhyāduhitṛbhrūvilāsaḥ śaśaviṣāṇaṃ khapuṣpaṃ ca syāt. na cāsti tasmād anumīyate pradhāne prāg utpatter mahadādikam asty eva.* "In this world, it is only that which [already] exists that comes to exist: there is no production of [that which is] nonexistent. If there were [such a production of something nonexistent], then sesame oil would come from grains of sand, a woven blanket would be [made] of tortoise hairs, a playful movement of the eyebrows [would be performed] by the daughter of a barren woman, [and] a hare's horn and a flower in the sky would exist. And [such things] do not exist; therefore one infers that [the evolutes] beginning with the Great, etc. do exist in matter before their arising." Cf. the way the first reason for *satkāryavāda* is summed up by Bhāsarvajña in the NBhūṣ, p. 567: *yady asat kriyate śaśaviṣāṇādy api kriyate, na tu kriyate; tasmāt sad eva kāryam.* "If [something] nonexistent is produced, [a nonexistent thing] such as a hare's horn too [should be] produced; but [in fact] no [such thing] is produced; therefore the effect necessarily exists [before the operation of its cause]."

same question regarding being [the property of] being vivid[ly perceived], etc.[62]

Another marginal annotation (also found in a footnote of the *Vimarśinī* edition in the Kashmir Series of Texts and Studies)[63] explains:

For the [following explanation] is not right: "just as butter is made manifest (*abhivyaktīkriyate*) from milk through a [churning-]stick and so on, in the same way, [the pot,] although [already] existing, is made manifest by the [potter's] stick, wheel and so on". [It is not right, for] does this very [property of] being the object of a manifestation have an existing or a nonexistent nature? If it does not exist, just as before[, one must state that no nonexistent thing can come to exist]; but if it exists, what is the point of becoming the object of manifestation [if the effect is already manifested]?[64]

The Sāṃkhya theory of *abhivyakti* is designed to answer the objection that a cause cannot produce an already existing effect, but it hardly solves the problem, because the manifestation of the effect by the cause can in turn be regarded as an effect, and the ontological status of this effect too is problematic: if the manifestation of the effect is some new property produced by the cause in the thus far unmanifested effect, then the *satkāryavādin* is guilty of self-contradiction, as he in fact admits that a nonexistent property can be brought to existence by the cause, so that his theory of manifestation is an *asatkāryavāda* in disguise; but if he considers that the *abhivyakti* is, like any other effect, something that already exists before the operation of the cause, then the operation of the cause becomes useless, since there is no point in revealing what is already manifest.

Why does Abhinavagupta allude to this argument? Since he refers to it in both of his commentaries, it is quite probable that it was stated in the lost *Vivṛti ad loc*, and that Utpaladeva was using it to show that the *satkāryavāda* as it is understood in the Sāṃkhya system is not consistent. But how is it that Abhinavagupta does not take the trouble of explaining it? One reason for this is certainly the fact that it was commonplace as a criticism of the Sāṃkhya *satkāryavāda*. In the *Nyāyavārttika*, Uddyotakara had already pointed out that however the manifestation brought about by the cause may be conceived, it is contradictory with *satkāryavāda* since it

[62] Manuscript S8 (image no. 126, right margin): *yat tūcyate, ghaṭaḥ sann eva kāraṇavyāpāreṇābhivyajyata iti nanu sābhivyaktiḥ saty asatī vā. satī ced vyarthaḥ kāraṇavyāpāraḥ. asatī ced asataḥ sattāpādanam aśakyaṃ śaśaviṣāṇasyeva, evaṃ sphuṭatvādiṣv api paryanuyojyam.*

[63] See fn. 17 in ĪPV, vol. II, p. 139, which is identical to the marginal annotation found on the right margin of the same passage in D2. The editors do not give information as to the origin of the footnotes, but they were obviously taken from marginal annotations in ĪPV manuscripts. These annotations are often of great interest: some of them contain quotations of Utpaladeva's almost entirely lost *Vivṛti* (on these quotations see Kawajiri forthcoming, Ratié forthcoming a, forthcoming b). Besides, as noted in Torella (2007b, fn. 14, p. 544) (cf. Torella 2007c, fn. 8, p. 479; 2007d, fn. 11, p. 929), D2 seems to be one of the four manuscripts used by the editors of the Kashmir Series of Texts and Studies.

[64] Marginal annotation in D2 (above *abhivyaktiviṣayatvasphuṭatvādayo'pi*)=ĪPV, fn. 17, p. 139: *daṇḍacakrādibhir hi yathā dadhno navanītaṃ daṇḍādinābhivyaktīkriyate tathā sann api*[1] *vyaktīkriyata iti tad ayuktam, tad api cābhivyaktiviṣayatvādi kiṃ sadrūpam utāsadrūpam asattve*[2] *pūrvavat sattve punaḥ kim abhivyaktiviṣayatveneti.* [[1]*sann api* conj.: *sad api* ĪPV, D2; [2]*asattve* conj.: *asattvaṃ* ĪPV, D2.]

involves the arising of something new, and if it does not, the causes are useless.[65] Jayanta Bhaṭṭa's *Nyāyamañjarī* puts forward a similar reasoning,[66] but this criticism

[65] NV, pp. 458–459: *athābhivyaktyartham upādānam iti keyam abhivyaktir nāma yopādānena kriyate. yadi kāryam, vyāhatam. atha kāryadharmaḥ, tathāpy anivṛtto vyāghātaḥ. athopalabdhiḥ kāryaviṣayābhivyaktiḥ*[1] *sā kriyata iti, na mucyase vyāghātāt. atha kāraṇātmanāvasthitasya kāryātmanāvasthānam abhivyaktiḥ, evam apy anivṛtto vyāghātaḥ, kāryātmanāvasthānam asad bhavatīti. atha kāraṇasya saṃsthānaviśeṣo'bhivyaktiḥ, saṃsthānaviśeṣo'bhūtvā bhavatīti vyāghātaḥ. athāsti, vyarthaṃ tadartham upādānam. atha kāraṇasya svalakṣaṇapuṣṭir abhivyaktiḥ, nāpūrvotpādābhāve svalakṣaṇapuṣṭiśabdārthaṃ paśyāma iti vyartham upādānam. svalakṣaṇapuṣṭiś ca pūrvam abhūtvā paścād bhavatīti vyāghātān na mucyasa iti. evaṃ yena yena kalpenābhivyaktir abhidhīyate, tena tena sat kāryaṃ bādhata iti.* [1*athopalabdhiḥ kāryaviṣayābhivyaktiḥ* conj.: *athopalabdhikāryaviṣayābhivyaktiḥ* NV.] "If [you say] that one has recourse [to a cause] (*upādāna*) so as to [produce] a manifestation (*abhivyakti*), [we ask:] what is this so-called manifestation produced by having recourse [to a cause]? If it is a [new] effect, this is contradictory [with the *satkāryavāda*]; if it is a [new] property of the effect, even so, the contradiction does not cease. If [you reply] that what is produced is a manifestation [consisting in] a perception that has the effect as its object, you do not escape contradiction [since the perception is new]. If manifestation is the existence in the form of the effect of what used to exist in the form of the cause, even so, the contradiction does not cease, since the existence in the form of the effect is nonexistent [before the operation of the cause]. If manifestation is a particular arrangement of the cause, this particular arrangement comes to exist after being nonexistent, therefore [once again] there is a contradiction [with your own principle; but] if [you reply] that [this manifestation conceived as a particular arrangement] does exist [before the operation of the cause,] then having recourse [to a cause] so as to [bring it about] is useless. If [you reply] that this manifestation is the development of a specific characteristic (*svalakṣaṇa*) of the cause, [we answer] that if there is no arising of [something] new, we do not see the meaning of the expression 'development of the specific characteristic', so that having recourse [to a cause] is useless; and since this development of the specific characteristic comes to exist after being first nonexistent, you do not escape contradiction. Thus whichever method [you use] to define manifestation contradicts [the doctrine that] the effect exists [before the operation of the cause]."

[66] NM(M), vol. II, p. 400/NM(V), vol. II, p. 293: *atha pūrvaṃ śaktyātmanā*[1] *tasyāstitvam idānīm*[2] *abhivyaktyātmanā kriyata iti tad apy anupapannam. abhivyaktir api tatsvarūpād bhinnābhinnā vā saty asatī veti vikalpyamānā na pūrvoktaṃ doṣam ativartate.* [1*śaktyātmanā* NM(V): *śaktayātmanā* NM(M). 2*idānīm* NM(V): *idīnīm* NM(M).] "As for [this contention of the Sāṃkhya opponent:] 'the [effect] existed before in the form of a potentiality (*śakti*), [whereas] now [its existence] is produced in the form of a manifestation (*abhivyakti*)'—this too is impossible: this manifestation in turn, whether considered to be distinct from the nature of the [effect] or not, whether considered to be existing or not, does not escape the previously stated fault." The fault alluded to here is the fact that if the pot already exists in the form of the pot before the operation of the causal factors producing it, these causal factors are useless, whereas if the pot only exists in the form of the lump of clay, it is nothing but the lump of clay (so that in fact the effect "pot" is nonexistent in the clay and the *satkāryavāda* is refuted). See Ibid.: *kena tu*[1] *rūpeṇa tadānīṃ kāryaṃ sad iti manyase*[2]*? yadi kārakavyāpārābhinirvartyena salilāharaṇādyarthakriyāsamarthena pṛthubudhnodarākāravatā rūpeṇa*[3] *cakramūrdhni*[4] *ghaṭo'stīti*[5] *– tadābhivyaktenāpi rūpeṇa sattvād atyantāya kārakavyāpāravaiphalyam… atha mṛtpiṇḍarūpeṇa tadānīṃ ghaṭo'stīti kathyate, na tarhy asau*[6] *tadānīṃ ghaṭo'sti, mṛpiṇḍa evāsāv asti*[7]. [1*kena tu* NM(M): *kena* NM(V). 2*manyase* NM(M): *manyate* NM(V). 3*pṛthubudhnodarākāravatā rūpeṇa* NM(M): *pṛthubudhnodarākāratārūpeṇa* NM(V).4*cakramūrdhni* corr.: *cakramūrdhani* NM(M), NM(V).5'*stīti* NM(M): '*sti* NM(V). 6*na tarhy asau* NM(M): *tatra na hy asau* NM(V).7 *evāsāv asti* NM(M): *evāsāv ado* NM(V).] "But in which form do you consider that the effect exists then[, before the operation of the cause]? If [you reply] that the pot [already] exists on the surface of the [potter's] wheel [where the lump of clay is, and that it exists there] as [it does when it is] the result of the operation of the factors of action, in a form capable of the efficacy [characterizing a pot, namely,] transporting e.g. water, [and] endowed with the aspect [characteristic of the pot, namely,] a large base and a cavity, then, since [it] exists in a form that is also manifest (*abhivyakta*), the operation of the factors of action is forever useless […]. [On the other hand,] if [you] say that the pot [only] exists at that time in the form of the lump of clay, then at that time, it is not a pot, it is nothing but a lump of clay!"

is also found in Buddhist sources such as the *Tattvasaṅgraha*.[67] In the *Nyāyabhūṣaṇa*, Bhāsarvajña explains that if the manifestation is conceived as nonexistent before its production, the *satkāryavāda* is refuted, but if it does exist before, the factors involved in its production are useless, and if the Sāṃkhya argues that just as any effect, the manifestation of the effect first exists in an unmanifest state before being revealed by the cause, his reasoning is doomed to an infinite regress, since the manifestation of the pot needs to be manifested by another manifestation, etc.[68] And while endeavouring to justify *Sāṃkhyakārikā* 9, Vācaspatimiśra takes into account a criticism of the Sāṃkhya notion of *abhivyakti* that includes not only the alternative between the two undesirable consequences (if the *abhivyakti* already exists, the causes are useless, but if it does not, the *satkāryavāda* is refuted) but also the idea that if the manifestation already exists in some unmanifest form, the Sāṃkhya reasoning is lost in an infinite regress.[69] It is also worth noting in this regard that the *Nyāyavārttika* and *Nyāyamañjarī*, while examining the notion of *abhivyakti*, mention several possible ways of understanding

[67] See TS 20 (answering the Sāṃkhya objection quoted above, fn. 42): *prāg āsīd yady asāv evaṃ na kiṃcid dattam uttaraṃ / no cet so'sat kathaṃ tebhyaḥ prādurbhāvaṃ samaśnute //* "If this [additional feature that is manifestation] existed before [the operation of the causes], thus [in fact you] have given no answer [to our objections that what is nonexistent cannot be produced and that the causes are not causes if they do not produce anything; but] if [this manifestation] did not [exist before the operation of the causes], how can this nonexistent [manifestation] reach the state of manifestation thanks to the [causes]?". Cf. TSP, p. 26: *tatra vikalpadvayam, kadācid asāv atiśayo'bhivyaktyādyavasthātaḥ prāk prakṛtyavasthāyām apy āsīd vā na vā, yady āsīt tadā bhavadbhir dvayor api hetvor na kiṃcid asiddhatvādikam uktam uttaram, no cet prāg āsīd evam api so'tiśayaḥ kathaṃ tebhyo hetubhyaḥ prādurbhāvam aśnuvīta, asadakāraṇād iti bhavatāṃ nyāyān na yuktam etad ity abhiprāyaḥ.* "In this respect there is a dilemma: either this additional feature [that you define as manifestation] existed at some point in the state of primordial nature as well, before the state of manifestation and so on; or it did not. If it existed [before], then with respect to the two reasons [that we have adduced, namely, that something that already exists cannot be produced and that consequently the causes are not causes], the answer that [you] stated [when you argued in reply that these reasons] are not established, etc., is nothing. But if this [additional feature] did not exist before, even so, how could the additional feature reach the state of manifestation thanks to the causes? This is not possible because of your own rule, 'because there is no production of what is nonexistent'—this is [Śāntarakṣita's] intention [in this verse]."

[68] NBhūṣ, p. 459: *kāryasyābhivyaktiḥ kāraṇena kriyata iti cet, sā yady asatī kriyate, tato'sat kāryaṃ syāt. satī ced abhivyaktis tadavasthaṃ kārakānarthakyam. abhivyakter apy abhivyaktiḥ kriyata iti cet, sāpi satī syād asatī vety aparyavasānam.* "If [the Sāṃkhya opponent explains] that [it is] the manifestation (*abhivyakti*) of the effect [that] is produced by the cause, [we answer the following:] if this [manifestation] is produced while being nonexistent, then let [us] admit that the effect is nonexistent [before the operation of the cause]. [But] if the manifestation [already] exists [before the operation of the cause], the same uselessness of the factors of action ensues. If [the opponent replies] that this manifestation is produced by another manifestation, might this other [manifestation] be existing [before the operation of its cause] or not?—[thus there is] an infinite regress."

[69] TK, p. 102: *syād etat. āvirbhāvaḥ paṭasya kāraṇavyāpārāt prāk sann asan vā. sa ced asan prāptam asata utpādanam. atha san kṛtaṃ tarhi karaṇena. na hi sati kāraṇāṇāṃ vyāpāraṃ paśyāmaḥ. āvirbhāve cāvirbhāvāntarakalpanenānavasthāprasaṅgaḥ.* "Let us admit that this [objection is raised by the opponent]: 'the manifestation of the cloth is either existing or nonexistent before the operation of [its] cause. If [you, Sāṃkhya, answer that] it is nonexistent, the arising of a nonexistent [thing, i.e. the very thesis against which you are fighting,] ensues. But if [you reply that it is] existing, then the [very notion of a] production is over. For we do not see any operation of causes with respect to that which [already] exists. Besides, if this manifestation [already exists in some unmanifest state before the operation of its cause], there follows an infinite regress, because [one has to] postulate another manifestation [manifesting it, etc.].'"

this manifestation, and among these definitions they allude to the thesis that *abhivyakti* is a "perception" (*upalabdhi*, *pratīti*) of the effect produced by the cause: Abhinavagupta might have this interpretation of the term *abhivyakti* in mind when alluding to the property of "being vivid[ly perceived], etc." (*sphuṭatvādi*).[70]

But most importantly, this criticism is expounded in the work of Utpaladeva's master, Somānanda:

> [Let us] consider [the following objection] (*cet*) [to the *satkāryavāda*]. The effect cannot exist [before the operation of its cause], because there is no point in the production of [that which already] exists. [If the Sāṃkhya answers]: "But what is produced in this case is [merely] the manifestation (*abhivyakti*) of this [effect]", this [manifestation] itself, is it produced while [already] existing or while being nonexistent? If [the Sāṃkhya replies that it already exists], how is it that this [already] existing [manifestation] is not perceived? If [the Sāṃkhya opponent replies]: "because there is no manifestation [of this already existing manifestation]", there is an infinite regress; alternatively, [if he had rather reply that this manifestation is produced while being nonexistent], this nonexistent [manifestation] is capable of destroying the thesis on which [he] himself relies: in the same way, the thing [regarded as the effect] should be [admitted to be] nonexistent [before its production].[71]

[70] See NV, pp. 458-459 (quoted above, fn. 65) and NM(M), vol. II, p. 400/NM(V), vol. II, p. 294: *kā ceyam abhivyaktiḥ. kiṃ kāryātmanāvasthānaṃ, atha saṃsthānaviśeṣa uta pratītir iti. yadi kāryātmanāvasthānaṃ tat pūrvaṃ nābhūt, tad adhunā bhūtam ity asat kāryam. pūrvam api vā yadi tad āsīt, tadā punaḥ kārakavaiphalyam. saṃsthānam apy avayavasanniveśaviśeṣaḥ. sa cāsann eva kriyate*[1]*, avayavās tu santīti kasyātra vivādaḥ. na hi*[2] *paramāṇavo'smābhir nāṅgīkṛtāḥ. pratītis tu ghaṭasya cakṣurādikārakasāmagryadhīnatve'pi*[3] *mṛtpiṇḍadaṇḍacakrādikārakacakrasādhyeti sā cakramūrdhni*[4] *ghaṭasya nāsty eveti asan ghaṭaḥ.*[[1]*sa cāsann eva kriyate* NM(M): *sann eva te* NM(V). [2]*hi* NM(M): *khalu* NM(V). [3]*cakṣurādikārakasāmagryadhīnatve'pi* NM(V): *cakṣurādikārakasāmagryadhīnā, na* NM(M). [4]*cakramūrdhni* corr.: *cakramūrdhani* NM(M), NM(V).] "And what is this manifestation? Is it the state [of existing] in the form of the effect? Or is it a particular arrangement? Or is it a perception? If it is the state [of existing] in the form of the effect, it did not exist before, [and] it exists now [that the causes have acted]—therefore the effect is nonexistent [before the causal operation]. If, alternatively, [you consider that] it existed before [the causal operation], then, the factors of action are once more useless. As for the arrangement [in which the manifestation supposedly consists], it is a particular arrangement of the parts; and this [particular arrangement] is produced while being nonexistent [before the production; if you reply that] nonetheless, the parts exist [before the causal operation bringing them together], what disagreement could there be in this respect? For we do not deny [the existence of] atoms. As for the perception of the pot, although [it] depends on the set of conditions that are the factors of action such as the visual organ and so on, it can only be produced thanks to the set of factors of action such as the lump of clay, the stick, wheel and so on, therefore there can be no [perception] of the pot on the surface of the wheel [where the lump of clay is before the potter makes a pot of it]—therefore the pot is nonexistent [in this lump of clay]." Note also that the TS 19 mentions "manifestation and so on" (*abhivyaktyādi*, see above, fn. 42), and the TSP ad loc. (p. 26) explains that "the expression 'and so on' includes a particular state such as predominance (*udreka*), etc. (*ādiśabdenodrekādyavasthāviśeṣaparigrahaḥ*). Determining whether these various ways of understanding the notion of *abhivyakti* in fact correspond to different Sāṃkhya theories or if Uddyotakara and Jayanta are merely pointing out the ambiguity of this notion is a difficult task, and one beyond the scope of this article. It should be noted, however, that the Buddhist Dharmottara distinguishes two Sāṃkhya theories regarding the transformation of the material cause into effects, one that involves the notion of manifestation (*abhivyakti*) and one that does not (see Watanabe 2011, p. 561).

[71] ŚD 4.35–37ab: *sat kāryaṃ nopapannaṃ cet sataḥ kiṃ karaṇena yat / abhivyaktir athāsyātra kriyate sāpi kiṃ satī // kriyate hy asatī vātha satyāḥ kiṃ nopalabdhatā / vyaktyabhāvād athānantyam asatyā hānisaṃbhavaḥ // svayam evāśrite pakṣe tadvad vā vastv asad bhavet /*

In his commentary on this passage of the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, Utpaladeva himself explains the Sāṃkhya's predicament in the following way:

> But let us consider (*yadi*) [the following objection]. The effect cannot have an [already] existing nature [before the operation of its cause], because the production of an [already] existing [thing] is useless (*viphala*). If [the Sāṃkhya replies that] it is not the [very] nature of the existing [effect] that is produced, but rather, the [mere] manifestation of this [effect], this is not correct either for the [following] reason: should this [manifestation] be produced while [already] existing or while being nonexistent? Among these [two options,] if [the Sāṃkhya replies that this manifestation is produced] while [already] existing, then what is produced [by the cause]? [And] how is it that the effect [which is this manifestation] is not perceived? If [the Sāṃkhya opponent replies that] although this manifestation [already] exists, because there is no manifesting agent (*abhivyaktṛ*) [in the form of a cause, we] do not perceive the effect [that is this manifestation], then it is through [another] manifestation that this manifestation is produced; so because the previously mentioned fault occurs here again, there is an infinite regress (*ānantya=anavasthā*), and therefore the perception of the effect, which is the topic of this discussion, cannot occur. But [if the Sāṃkhya opponent had rather reply that] this manifestation is produced while being nonexistent, then since [according to him] there is a production of [that which is] nonexistent, there follows the refutation of the thesis on which [he] himself relies. [That is to say:] alternatively, if, in order to get rid of the infinite regress regarding this manifestation, [the opponent had rather] rely on [the thesis that the manifestation] is produced [while being] nonexistent, [then] just as this manifestation, the thing too [that is manifested]—a sprout for instance—is necessarily nonexistent; [therefore] what is the point of this [maxim of] a half-senile woman (*ardhajaratīya*)[72]: "one must admit that the effect is [already] existing"?[73]

Thus the reason why Abhinavagupta does not bother to explain this reasoning essentially lies in the fact that Utpaladeva had already explained it in some detail in

[72] One could understand the expression as simply qualifying a statement worthy of a half-senile woman, i.e. absurd. However, see Apte (1959, Appendix E), s.v. *ardhajaratīyanyāyaḥ*, which quotes the explanation given in Vardhamāna's *Gaṇaratnamahodadhi* 3.195: *yathā strī na taruṇī ślathastanatvāt kṛṣṇakeśatvān na jaratī vaktuṃ śakyate tadvat siddhāsiddhaṃ prayojanam.* "Just as a woman who is not young because her breasts are flaccid cannot be said to be old [either] because her hair is black, in the same way, the purpose is both accomplished and unaccomplished." In other words, according to this interpretation, the opponent of the *satkāryavāda* depicted here accuses the Sāṃkhya of contradicting himself by stating both that the effect exists before the operation of its cause and that its manifestation does not exist before the operation of its cause.

[73] ŚDV, pp. 161–162: *atha yadi sadrūpaṃ kāryaṃ nopapannaṃ sataḥ karaṇaṃ viphalaṃ yasmāt. atha sataḥ svarūpaṃ na kriyate, api tu tasyābhivyaktis tad api na yuktaṃ yataḥ sāpi kiṃ satī kriyeta athāsatī. tatra satī ced abhivyaktis tat kiṃ kriyate kimiti kāryasya nopalabdhatā. atha sattve'py abhivyakter abhivyaktrabhāvāt kāryaṃ nopalabdhaṃ tad abhivyakter apy abhivyaktiḥ kriyata iti tatrāpi pūrvoktāt pātād ānantyam anavasthā, tataś ca prakṛtakāryadarśanānirvṛttiḥ. athāsatī kriyate'bhivyaktis tad asatyāḥ karaṇe svayam āśritapakṣahāniprasaṅgaḥ. anavasthāparihārārthaṃ vābhivyaktāv asatkaraṇāśrayaṇe'bhivyaktivad vastv apy aṅkurādikam asad eva sat kāryam astu kim ardhajaratīyena.*

his commentary to the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, but it would not be too wild a guess to assume that he also explained it in his lost *Vivṛti*, because Abhinavagupta alludes to it in both of his commentaries, but also because the structure of Utpaladeva's argument as it is explained by Abhinavagupta closely follows that of the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, which has an opponent of the *satkāryavāda* express the principle that an already existing effect does not need to be brought to existence (a principle which, as we have seen, is explicitly stated in verse 2.4.3) before letting the Sāṃkhya put forward his theory of *abhivyakti* and finally formulating the dilemma with which the opponent of the *satkāryavāda* defeats the Sāṃkhya.

But if Utpaladeva did eliminate the Sāṃkhya solution to the problem of causality in his *Vivṛti* before stating his own, he must also have explained *why his solution is superior*, or in other words, why, contrary to the Sāṃkhya notion of *abhivyakti*, his own definition of causality *cannot be subjected to the dilemma* just mentioned. And in this regard as well, Abhinavagupta's commentaries contain important clues.

Why Does Utpaladeva's Solution Escape the Criticism of the Sāṃkhya *Abhivyakti* According to Abhinavagupta?

The crucial passage in the *Vimarśinī* occurs right after Abhinavagupta has explained Utpaladeva's definition of causality as the apparent externalization of an all-powerful consciousness manifesting itself in the form of an object of knowledge external to the subject.[74] Abhinavagupta adds:

> And one cannot say that being an object of knowledge for both [internal and external] sense organs is in turn either existing or nonexistent [before the operation of the cause], because the [following] is the ultimate truth as regards this [property of being the object of sense organs:] just as, when there is a reflection, inside a mirror, of e.g. a pot that is [in the process of] being created[75] by a potter [also reflected in the mirror],[76] the might (*mahiman*) of such a manifestation belongs to the mirror alone; in the same way, [when there is a reflection,] in the vision of a dream, [of a pot being created by a potter, the might of such a manifestation] belongs to [the dreaming] consciousness.[77]

[74] ĪPV, vol. II, p. 141: *tataḥ saṃvid eva viśvam ātmani bhāsayati śaktivaicitryāt. tasya kasyāpīti pūrvam uktasyācintyāparyanuyojyamahimna ity arthaḥ.* "Therefore it is consciousness itself that manifests everything in itself thanks to the variety of [its] powers. [The words:] 'this prodigious entity' [in the verse] mean this [entity, i.e. consciousness], that has been described earlier [and] the might (*mahiman*) of which is beyond rational examination (*acintya*) and cannot be put into question (*aparyanuyojya*)."

[75] See *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 158, which emphasizes the notion of process entailed by the present participle: *nirvartyamānaḥ – asmin samaya eva kriyamāṇaḥ, na tu nirvartitaḥ.* "It is being created—[i.e.,] it is being made at that very moment, but it is not [yet] finished."

[76] See *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 158: *ādiśabdena kumbhakāranirvartyamānatādigrahaṇam.* "Because of the expression 'e.g.' (*ādi*) [in 'e.g. a pot'], one must understand [that there is also a reflection in this mirror] of the potter creating [the pot], etc."

[77] See *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 148: *saṃvidaḥ – svapnasaṃvidaḥ.*

> [And] even though [this is the case],[78] there arises, through the very might of this [consciousness,] this [erroneous] conviction (*abhimāna*): "this [thing,] which has a form vivid[ly manifest] (*sphuṭa*) outside [of consciousness,] is produced by that [potter]." Thus, whereas the potter, [his] stick, wheel and so on, [and] the pot are [all] made to exist (*avasthita*) by the might of consciousness, this very might of [consciousness] produces an [erroneous] conviction such as "I have done this", "he has done this", "[it is] in my heart [that] this has flashed forth [in the form of a creative intention]", "[it is] in his heart [that] this has flashed forth [in the form of a creative intention]". [And] since in this [case,] it is out of the question that the [erroneous] conviction may belong to an insentient [entity] such as clay, it is established that agency (*kartṛtva*) lies in the nature of consciousness.[79]

Abhinavagupta is arguing here that Utpaladeva's definition of the relation of cause and effect cannot be subjected to the problematic dilemma in which the Sāṃkhya notion of *abhivyakti* ends up: one cannot ask if the manifestation of the pot as an external entity is in turn existing or not before the operation of its cause, because the real cause of the pot as an external manifestation is not the potter, nor his instruments, nor the clay, which are, just as the pot, external manifestations of consciousness; the real cause of the pot, but also of the potter, his instruments and the clay, and even the real cause of our conviction that the cause of the pot is the potter, is nothing but consciousness.[80] As Abhinavagupta puts it elsewhere, it is the universal consciousness that is the real potter,[81] since even the potter's conviction that he is an agent creating a pot and his will to create are ultimately creations of the

[78] Here my understanding differs from that of Bhāskarakaṇṭha (*Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 158: *yady api kumbhakāreṇa nirvartyamānatayaiva grahaṇam asti tathāpīty arthaḥ.* "'Even so' means: although one only grasps [the pot] as being created by the potter…'" It seems to me that Abhinavagupta rather means: *although consciousness is solely responsible for the creation of this pot*, we do not realize that it is the case because, due to the very power of consciousness, we are led to believe that the pot and the pot's creator are two distinct entities existing outside of consciousness.

[79] ĪPV, vol. II, p. 141: *na ca vācyam ubhayendriyavedyatvam api sad asad veti, yato'yam atra paramārtho yathā darpaṇāntaḥ kumbhakāranirvartyamānaghaṭādipratibimbe darpaṇasyaiva tathāvabhāsanamahimā, tathā svapnadarśane saṃvidaḥ. tathāpi tanmahimnaivaitenedaṃ bahiḥ sphuṭarūpaṃ kriyata ity abhimāna ullasati. evaṃ saṃvinmahimnā kumbhakṛti daṇḍacakrādau ghaṭe'vasthite tanmahimnaivābhimāno jāyate yathā mayedaṃ kṛtam, anenedaṃ kṛtam, mama hṛdaye sphuritam, asya hṛdaye sphuritam iti. tatra jaḍasya mṛdāder dūrāpeto'bhimāna iti saṃvitsvabhāve kartṛtvaṃ vyavasthāpyate.*

[80] Cf. the parallel passage in ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 187: *yathā hi darpaṇasvapnasaṃkalpeṣu kumbhakāranirmīyamāṇo'yaṃ ghaṭa ity ābhāse'pi tattvato darpaṇādikasyaiva mahimā, tathaiva saṃvida eva ghaṭābhāse mahimā kumbhakāranirmīyamāṇatvābhimānābhāsanotthāpane'pi.* "For just as, in mirrors, dreams or imaginary representations, even as regards this manifestation: 'this pot is being made by a potter', in fact the might [of this manifestation] solely belongs to the mirror, [dream or imaginary construction], exactly in the same way, as regards the manifestation of a [perceived] pot, the might [of this manifestation] solely belongs to consciousness—even as regards the arising of the manifestation of the conviction that [the pot] is being made by a potter."

[81] Cf. e.g. ĪPV, vol. II, p. 148: *ataś ca kumbhakṛd eva tatreśvaraḥ*. "And as a consequence, in this [operation consisting in making a pot,] the Lord is the potter himself." See also MŚV 1.310cd–311ab: *na hi kumbhakṛtaḥ kvāpi kadācit kartṛtā bhavet // yadi nāsau maheśākhyāt kartur avyatirekabhāk /* "For a potter is never an agent of anything if he is distinct from the agent called the Great Lord."

universal consciousness[82]: what we ordinarily take to be causes as well as effects are nothing but ways in which consciousness appears to itself.

But how is this idea that consciousness is the ultimate cause of everything a solution to the problem of *abhivyakti* to which Abhinavagupta has alluded before? Abhinavagupta does not offer any explicit justification of this point, and this is most unfortunate since it is obviously the crux of the whole argument. One may surmise once again that Abhinavagupta does not endeavour to make it clear here because Utpaladeva's lost *Vivṛti* contained such an explanation; but at any rate, in order to understand it, we must have recourse to a number of other Śaiva texts, and primarily to Utpaladeva's commentary on the *Śivadṛṣṭi*.

Somānanda's Own Criticism of the Sāṃkhya Notion of Manifestation

As a matter of fact, the fourth chapter of Somānanda's work contains a long discussion on the *satkāryavāda*, and its author argues there that the Sāṃkhya theory of causality only makes sense if one admits that Śiva, understood as the universal and dynamic consciousness, exists in the form of both the cause and the effect.[83] One interesting

[82] See e.g. TĀ 9.36cd–37ab and 38cd–39ab, quoted by Bhāskarakaṇṭha (see *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 159) while he comments on the ĪPV passage examined here: *kumbhakārasya yā saṃvic cakradaṇḍādiyojane // śiva eva hi sā yasmāt saṃvidaḥ kā viśiṣṭatā /… tasmād ekaikanirmāṇe śivo viśvaikavigrahaḥ // karteti puṃsaḥ kartṛtvābhimāno'pi vibhoḥ kṛtiḥ /* "For the potter's consciousness [engaged] in using together the wheel, stick and so on is nothing but Śiva; since what difference could there be [between Him] and this consciousness? Therefore, with respect to each [particular] creation, the agent is Śiva, whose body is one with the universe; even the individual's conviction that [he] is an agent is a creation of the Lord." Cf. e.g. ĪPV, vol. II, pp. 149–150: *tathāpi samastetaranirmāṇamadhya evedam api parameśvareṇaiva nirmitaṃ yad avicalas tasya kumbhakārapaśor mithyākartṛtvābhimānaḥ pratibhuva ivādhamarṇatābhimānaḥ. yadi punar īśvarasyecchaiveyam īdṛśī māsyābhimāno'yam udgamad iti tadā nāsau kartā kaścit. kumbhakārasyāpi mṛdādisaṃskārakrameṇa kiṃ ghaṭaṃ janayāmi, uta na janayāmīti ya ekapakṣaniścayāya saṃpraśnātmā vicāraḥ, sa īśvarasaṃbandhina eva vividhāt svarūpāvacchādanatattvaprakāśanarūpād avasthānāt.* "Nonetheless, in the midst of the creation of all other [things,] the Highest Lord himself has created the erroneous (*mithyā*) conviction (*abhimāna*), firm[ly rooted within the individual,] that the enslaved individual (*paśu*) who is the potter is an agent—[a conviction] similar to that of a moneylender who would think that he is the debtor. But if this same will of the Lord is such: 'this conviction shall not arise in him', then this [individual] is no agent at all. Even the pondering of a potter, which consists in a question [that he asks himself] so as to choose an option [in the form:] 'should I produce a pot through a succession of operations on the clay and so on, or not?' comes from [what Utpaladeva calls] a complex arrangement that exclusively belongs to the Lord and that consists [both] in a concealment of his own nature and in a manifestation of reality."

[83] ŚD 33cd–34: *ito'pi sarvaśivatā sata utpattiyogataḥ // sa evāste purā tādṛkśaktirūpasvarūpakaḥ / sa eva kāryarūpeṇa bhagavān avakalpate //* "For this [following reason] as well, [namely,] because [only an already] existing [entity] can arise [as an effect,] everything is Śiva: it is [Śiva] who continuously exists (*āste*) up to now, [since he] has as his nature the form of such a power; only the Lord is fit (*avakalpate*) [for existing] in the form of the effect." Cf. ŚDV, p. 161: *ito'pi hetoḥ sarvaśivatā yasmād utpattimadbhāvajātaṃ sad evotpadyate tatsvabhāvasya kāryātmanaḥ prāg api viruddhāsattāsaṃsparśāyogāt. tad eva ca prāg api sadaṅkurarūpaṃ syāt, yadi sattāsatattvo'ṅkuraḥ śaktirūpaḥ pūrvam āste punar aṅkurātmakakāryarūpeṇa bhavati.* "For this reason as well, [namely], because all the entities that arise arise only while [already] existing, due to the impossibility for that which has this nature [of arising and] which consists in an effect of being in contact with nonexistence, which is contradictory [with existence,] even before [it arises], everything is Śiva. And this very [effect] must have the form of an [already] existing sprout even before [it arises as such], if the sprout, which has as its reality existence [and] takes the form of a potentiality, exists before [and] then exists in the form of the effect consisting of a sprout."

aspect of this chapter is that Somānanda points out there what constitutes in his eyes the main defect of the Sāṃkhya theory of causality, namely, the very way in which manifestation is understood. So before examining the answer that Somānanda gives to the problem of *abhivyakti* examined above, it is worth understanding what he himself finds problematic about the Sāṃkhya notion of *abhivyakti*.

In a particularly telling passage, Somānanda reminds us that the Sāṃkhyas justify the preexistence of the effect in its cause by arguing that the effect can only arise if it is related to the factors of action,[84] so that it must exist when these factors of action engage in activity, because their action must be exerted *on something*: according to the *Yuktidīpikā*, the object on which the causes act, i.e. the effect, must exist when they start acting, otherwise the relation (*sambandha*) between the effect and the factors of action would remain inexplicable.[85] Contrary

[84] These factors of action (*kāraka*) are the various elements involved in the accomplishment of an action. On their role in Pāṇinian grammar, see e.g. Cardona (1974). The presupposition at the basis of this whole discussion is what Johannes Bronkhorst has called the "correspondence principle" (see e.g. Bronkhorst 2011, pp. 37 ff.), namely, the idea that the elements of a sentence must reflect elements of reality.

[85] See the answer to the opponent of Sāṃkhya in YD, pp. 117–118: *etac cānupapannam. kasmāt. saty asati vā sambandhe doṣaprasaṅgāt. tad dhi kriyamāṇaṃ sati vā sambandhe kārakaiḥ kriyate'sati vā. sambandhaś cāsya bhavan pravṛttikāle vā kārakāṇāṃ syān nivṛttikāle vā. kiṃ cātaḥ. tan na tāvat pravṛttikāle sambandho yuktaḥ. kasmāt. adravyatvāt. pravṛttikāle kartrādīnāṃ kriyāguṇavya-padeśābhāvād avastubhūtaṃ śaśaviṣāṇasthānīyaṃ vaḥ kāryaṃ na cāsti tathābhūtasya vastubhūtena sambandhaḥ. atha nivṛttikāle'bhisambadhyate yad uktaṃ sato niṣpannatvāt kriyānutpattir iti tasya vyāghātaḥ. atha matam asaty api sambandhe niṣpattir bhavatīti tena kārakavyāpāravaiyarthyaprasaṅgaḥ. prāg api ca kārakopādānāt kāryaniṣpattiprasaṅga iti. uktaṃ ca: asattvān nāsti sambandhaḥ kārakaiḥ sattvasaṅgibhiḥ / asambandhasya cotpattim icchato na vyavasthitiḥ // iti.* "And this[, i.e. a nonexistent effect,] is not possible. Why? Because there would follow a fault whether there is a relation (*sambandha*) [of the effect with the factors of action] or not. For that [which] is being produced is produced either while there is a relation with the factors of action, or while this [relation] does not exist. And [if we suppose that] the relation of this [effect with the factors of action] exists, it can exist either at the time when the factors of action are engaged in action or at the time when they cease to act. And what follows from this? To begin with, the relation is not possible [in your system] at the time when they are engaged in action. Why? Because [the effect] is not a substance: at the time when the agent and so on are engaged in action, because [the effect] has no action, property or name, for you this effect is not a real entity (*vastu*), [it is] comparable to a hare's horn, and there can be no relation of such a [non-being] with a real entity. [But] if [you reply that] it is related [with the factors of action] at the time when [these factors of action] cease to act, [this answer] is contradictory with [your own] statement that there can be no arising of action [when the effect already exists] because this [already] existing [entity] is [already] brought about. But if [you had rather hold] the thesis that [the effect] is brought about although there is no relation [of the effect with the factors of action], as a consequence [you must admit] the uselessness of the activity of the factors of action; moreover, as a consequence [you also have to admit] that the effect is brought about before one has recourse to the factors of action[, since one no longer needs them to produce the effect]. And it has been said [in this connection]: "If [the effect] is nonexistent, [it] has no relation with the factors of action, which are [necessarily] related to existing entities; and someone who admits the arising of [an effect] devoid of relation [with the factors of action] has no firm ground [but only an infinite regress]." Cf. TK, p. 98: *etad uktaṃ bhavati: kāryeṇa sambaddhaṃ kāraṇaṃ kāryajanakam. sambandhaś ca kāryasyāsato na bhavati. tasmāt sad iti.* "Here is [what the author of the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*-s] means: a cause produces an effect [if it is] related with the effect; and there is no relation of a nonexistent effect [with anything]—therefore [the effect] exists [before the operation of the cause]." Note that Vācaspatimiśra also quotes (ibid.) the verse found in YD, p. 118.

to other commentaries,[86] the *Yuktidīpikā* thus interprets the fifth reason for *satkāryavāda* adduced in *Sāṃkhyakārikā* 9 (*kāraṇabhāvāt*) as meaning that the effect must preexist the causal operation because in the world, we assume that such ordinary things as threads stand in a causal relationship with cloth, but if the effect did not exist before the causal operation, there could be no such relationship (since a relationship involves the existence of two relata), so that there would not be anything as a "cause" in our everyday life.[87] This interpretation, which is also mentioned in the *Tattvakaumudī*,[88] appears in Buddhist[89] and Jain[90] sources as well.

But Somānanda points out that according to this very reasoning (which was adopted by the dualist Śaivas),[91] the Sāṃkhya theory of *abhivyakti* is defective, since the action that is manifestation cannot take place unless the manifesting causes and the manifested effect exist at the same time. If one follows the very line of argument that the Sāṃkhyas use so as to prove the *satkāryavāda*, then *the*

[86] See Bronkhorst (2000) on the various interprations of the last reason in SK 9.

[87] See YD, p. 124: *ihāsati kārye kāraṇabhāvo nāsti tadyathā vandhyāyāḥ. asti ceha kāraṇabhāvas tantupaṭayoḥ. tasmāt sat kāryam.* "In this [world], if the effect is nonexistent, there is no causality (*kāraṇabhāva*)—just as a barren woman [has no causality]. Now, there is causality in this [world]; for instance, that of the threads and cloth. Therefore the effect exists."

[88] Admittedly, as noted in Bronkhorst (2000, p. 54), Vācaspatimiśra does not seem to understand it in this way since he gives a different interpretation (TK, pp. 98–100: *kāraṇabhāvāc ca kāryasya kāraṇātmakatvāt. na hi kāraṇād bhinnaṃ kāryaṃ kāraṇaṃ ca sad iti kathaṃ tadabhinnaṃ kāryam asad bhavet.* "[That the effect exists before the operation of its cause is] also [established] *kāraṇabhāvāt*, [i.e.], because [the effect] has as its nature the cause. For the effect is not distinct from the cause, and the cause exists; therefore how could the effect, which is not distinct from the [cause], be nonexistent?"). However, at the end of his commentary on SK 9 he does give the interpretation which is described in Bronkhorst (2000) as that of the YD. See TK, p. 104: *na ca paṭarūpeṇa kāraṇānāṃ sambandhaḥ, tadrūpasyākriyātvāt kriyāsambandhitvāc ca kāraṇānām, anyathā kāraṇatvābhāvāt. tasmāt sat kāryam iti puṣkalam.* "And there is no relation of the causes with the form of the cloth [if the cloth is nonexistent], because [they can]not [perform any] action on this [nonexistent] form, and because the causes [must] have [some kind of] action, since otherwise they would not be causes. Therefore the [thesis] that the effect [exists before the operation of the cause] is perfect[ly established]."

[89] See TS 13 (which, according to the introduction in TSP, p. 20, is stated "in order to demonstrate the fifth reason [for *satkāryavāda*]", *pañcamahetusamarthanārtham*): *kāryasyaivam ayogāc ca kiṃ kurvat kāraṇaṃ bhavet / tataḥ kāraṇabhāvo'pi bījāder na vikalpate //* "And because thus, the effect is impossible, on what could the cause be acting? Therefore [if the effect is nonexistent before the operation of the cause,] we cannot even assume the causality of the seed for instance."

[90] See Granoff (1999, p. 581) (which argues that the TS was used as a source by some Jain authors).

[91] See e.g. MT 1.9.17: *anyathā kārakavrātapravṛttyanupapattitaḥ / śrutir ādānam arthaś ca vyapaitīty api tad dhatam //* "Otherwise, because the activity of all the factors of action becomes impossible, since speech (*śruti*), the recourse [to means of action] and the goal [of actions must] disappear, [all] this is ruined." Cf. MTṬ, p. 198: *saty asadutpattyabhyupagame kārakavrātasyaiva pravṛttir nopapadyate. asato hi kāryasya vandhyāsutāder ivotpattaye kiṃ kila kārakāṇi kuryuḥ. kārakapravṛttyanupapatteś ca ghaṭādicikīrṣor mṛtpiṇḍādy ānayetyādikā śrutiḥ, teṣāṃ ca kārakāṇām ādānaṃ grahaṇam, arthaś ca tadvyāpāralakṣaṇā kriyā vyapaiti vighaṭate. tasmiṃś ca vyapete sarvaceṣṭāvyāghātaḥ, pratyuta yuṣmatpakṣe jagadvyāhataṃ syāt.* "If [we] admit that [it is] a nonexistent [effect that] arises, the activity of all factors of action without exception is impossible. For what on Earth could the factors of action do so as to [produce] the arising of an effect [as] nonexistent as the son of a barren woman for instance? And since [then] the activity of the factors of action is impossible, the speech of someone wishing to make e.g. a pot, such as 'bring the clay, etc.', as well as the recourse to these factors of action—[i.e.] the fact that one grasps [them] —, and the goal—[i.e.] the action characterized as an activity [aimed at] this [goal—must] disappear, [i.e. they] are ruined. And since this disappears, all activities are ruined: according to your thesis, the [whole] world even should be ruined."

manifestor and the manifested have to exist at the same time for manifestation to be possible; but according to the Sāṃkhya system, the effect, although it exists before its manifestation, is unmanifest before this manifestation occurs, so that manifestation remains inexplicable.[92] Utpaladeva thus explains:

> If [a Sāṃkhya were to say that] the relation [between the effect and the factors of action] exists (*vidyate*) since the effect, which exists [before its so-called production, already] consists in an effect [at that time and is therefore related to a cause], this too would not be [correct], because [in the Sāṃkhya system,] although this object to be produced—e.g. a pot—exists [before its so-called production, at that time] it is not an object for consciousness (*asaṃvedya*), and because due to the fact that it is not an object for consciousness, since this related [entity] is not perceptible, there can be no understanding of the relation [between the thing to be manifested and the manifesting entity,] and [as a consequence] the potter and [any other cause of the pot] cannot be the manifesting agent (*vyañjaka*) with respect to the pot, since there is no manifesting agent at all with respect to a reality [that supposedly exists] beyond the range of perception. [For] it is only when the object is established [i.e. manifested] that one considers [something] as a manifesting agent [of this manifestation]—for instance, a lamp with respect to [a manifested thing] such as a pot. Therefore, since there is no manifesting agent as well [as no manifested entity], how could there be any relation [between a manifesting cause and a manifested effect]?[93]

This is a difficulty that, according to the nondualist Śaivas, can only be overcome if we consider that the manifested entities involved in a causal process are nothing but one single manifesting entity: if the manifestor is also the manifested, then all the factors of action can exist (and therefore function) together so as to produce manifestation.

Admittedly, a Sāṃkhya objector could argue that his system allows for such an answer, since in his system one single entity, namely matter (*pradhāna*), constantly transforms itself, and it is this constant change that enables what we ordinarily call

[92] See ŚD 4.49cd–51ab: *janmakāle ghaṭābhāvāt sambandho naiva kārakaiḥ // nāsambaddhasya karaṇaṃ satkāryāc cet sa vidyate / sann apy asāv asaṃvedyo vyañjakasyāpy abhāvataḥ // tasmāt svayaṃ svabhāvena bhāvair bhāvī bhaved bhavaḥ /* "If the pot does not exist at the time of [its] production, [it] has no relation whatsoever with the factors of action[, and] there is no production of what is not related [to the factors of action]. If [the Sāṃkhya explains that] because the effect is existing, this [relation] exists (*vidyate*), [we answer that in the Sāṃkhya system,] although the [pot] exists [before its so-called production, at that time] it is not an object for consciousness (*asaṃvedya*), and because [therefore] there is no manifesting agent either, as a consequence, Bhava [i.e. the all-encompassing consciousness] must be (*bhavet*) that which constantly exists (*bhāvin*) by itself, due its own nature (*svabhāva*), as [all] the entities (*bhāva*)."

[93] ŚDV, pp. 169–170: *atha sa vidyate sambandhaḥ sataḥ kāryātmakatvāt kāryasya, tad api na, yataḥ sann apy asau janyo ghaṭādir artho'saṃvedyo'saṃvedyatvāc ca sambandhino'prakhyatvena sambandhāgamanaṃ vyañjakatvaṃ ca kumbhakārāder ghaṭaṃ prati nāsti yataḥ sarvathā pratītyagocare vastuni vyañjako na bhavati. siddha evārthe vyañjako mato yathā ghaṭādau dīpaḥ. tato vyañjakasyāpy abhāvataḥ kathaṃ sambandhaḥ.*

causes (clay, seeds, etc.) and effects (pots, sprouts, etc.) to appear.[94] But as Utpaladeva points out both in his Pratyabhijñā treatise and his commentary on the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, only one entity is capable of thus manifesting itself in various incompatible shapes without ceasing to exist as the same entity—namely, consciousness.[95] An insentient object cannot undergo a change of form without ceasing to exist as such: a square that ceases to have four sides ceases to be a square, because objects are subjected to the principle of non-contradiction and therefore cannot assume contradictory forms without de facto ceasing to exist.[96] But consciousness is the one entity that resists or transcends the principle of

[94] See Abhinavagupta's introductions to ĪPK 2.4.19. In ĪPV, vol. II, p. 176, the opponent thus argues: *nanu pradhānaṃ pariṇāmakriyāyāṃ kartṛrūpam iyatā samarthitam iti ko doṣo, na hi puruṣavad asyākartṛtvam iṣyata iti.* "But through the [arguments expounded] so far, [you] have demonstrated that matter (*pradhāna*) consists in the agent of the action of transformation; therefore what is the fault [in the Sāṃkhya theory of causality]? For [the Sāṃkhyas] do not consider that this [matter] has no agency, contrary to the Person (*puruṣa*) [who remains inactive]." Cf. the objection to the same effect in ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 234: *nanv iyatoktena pradhānasya kartṛtvaṃ samarthitaṃ bhavet, na cidrūpasya; tac ca nāniṣṭaṃ parasyeti.* "But through [the arguments] expounded so far, [you] may have demonstrated the agency of matter, but not that of what consists in consciousness; and the [Sāṃkhya] opponent does not deny this [agency of matter]."

[95] See ĪPK 2.4.19: *na ca yuktaṃ jaḍasyaivaṃ bhedābhedavirodhataḥ / ābhāsabhedād ekatra cidātmani tu yujyate //* "And such [an agency] is not possible for [something] insentient, because of the contradiction between the difference and identity [that would ensue for this insentient entity] due to the difference between [various] manifestations [that transformation involves]; whereas it is possible in the unitary [entity] consisting in consciousness." Cf. *Vṛtti*, p. 60: *jaḍasyābhinnātmano bhedenāvasthiter virodhād ayuktam, svacche cidātmany ekasminn evam anekapratibimbadhāraṇenāvirodhād yujyate.* "[Agency] is not possible for an insentient [entity], because of the contradiction between the undifferentiated form [of any insentient entity and] the existence in different [forms that agency requires; but] such [an agency] is possible in the unitary [and] limpid [entity] consisting in consciousness, because [in it] there is no contradiction [between its unity and] its receiving manifold reflections (*pratibimba*)." See Torella (2002, p. 186). Cf. ŚDV, p. 171: *darpaṇavad viśvapratibimbayogi traiguṇyam ity abhyupagame'pi yadvaśāt tathāpratibimbayogas tad eva kāraṇam, tatrāpi bhedābhedaparyālocanād anupapattir iti cinmayaśivarūpataiva sarvakāryāṇām īśvarapratyabhijñoktanyāyena.* "Even if [we] admit that [matter defined] as the three constituents (*traiguṇya*) bears the reflection of the universe, like a mirror, the cause can only be that thanks to which [it] bears such a reflection; and since [we] perceive that [bearing such a reflection] involves both difference and identity, [matter] cannot be [the cause]. Therefore all effects [are indeed mere manifestations of the cause but] exclusively consist in Śiva, who is nothing but consciousness, according to the principle [stated in] the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* [treatise]."

[96] See ĪPV, vol. II, pp. 176–177: *evam ity abhinnarūpasya dharmiṇaḥ satatapravahadbahutaradharmabhedasaṃbhedasvātantryalakṣaṇaṃ pariṇamanakriyākartṛkatvaṃ yad uktaṃ tat pradhānāder na yuktaṃ jaḍatvāt. jaḍo hi nāma pariniṣṭhitasvabhāvaḥ prameyapadapatitaḥ; sa ca rūpabhedād bhinno vyavasthāpanīyo nīlapītādivat; ekasvabhāvatvāc*[1] *cābhinno nīlavat. na tu sa eva svabhāvo bhinnaś cābhinnaś ca bhavitum arhati vidhiniṣedhayor ekatraikadā virodhāt.* [[1]*ekasvabhāvatvāc* L, S1, S2, SOAS: *ekasvabhāvavattvāc* ĪPV, *Bhāskarī*: *ekasvabhāvāt* J.] "'Such [an agency' means the following.] The agency in the action that is transformation (*pariṇamana*)—which [Utpaladeva] has described [earlier] as characterized by the freedom (*svātantrya*) to divide and unite numerous, constantly flowing properties [and] as belonging to a property-bearer having an undivided nature—is not possible for [something] such as matter, because [matter] is insentient. For what [we] call insentient has a [self-]confined (*pariniṣṭhita*) nature, it has fallen into the state of object of knowledge; and [if we assume it to be such an agent, we] must declare that it is differentiated (*bhinna*) due to the difference between the [various] forms [that it supposedly assumes,] such as blue and yellow, etc.; and [yet], since it has a unitary nature, [it must be] undifferentiated, as the blue is. But the same nature cannot bear to be both differentiated and undifferentiated, because [this would entail] a contradiction between an affirmation and [its] negation with regard to the same [thing] at the same time."

non-contradiction, because it can freely assume incompatible forms without ceasing to exist, just as a mirror can reflect a multiplicity without being shattered by it: in imagination for instance, and even in one single perception, consciousness can take an infinite variety of forms that are incompatible with each other without ceasing to exist as a consciousness.[97] So the nondualist Śaivas claim that the main problem inherent in the Sāṃkhya theory of causality is its wrong representation of manifestation: manifestation can only occur if the manifesting and the manifested entity are not distinct, that is to say, if consciousness manifests things by assuming their various forms.

The Answer Given by the Nondualist Śaivas to the Classical *Abhivyakti* Criticism

Let us now examine how Somānanda addresses what could be termed the classical criticism of *abhivyakti*, that is, the argument showing that the *abhivyakti* itself can be either nonexistent before the operation of its cause (in which case the *satkāryavādin* contradicts himself) or existing (in which case the s*atkāryavādin* has to face an infinite regress). After explaining this criticism,[98] Somānanda's first move is to claim that it does not hold because it presupposes that the *satkāryavāda* principle should apply equally to every aspect of the system (so that the Sāṃkhya system supposedly condemns itself to contradiction if it admits that the manifestation of the effect does not preexist in its cause), whereas in fact other systems hold a number of principles that only apply to some of their components: one could well admit that every effect preexists in its cause without admitting that it is the case too as regards the manifestation of the effect, just as the Vaiśeṣikas for instance attribute agency to God but not to other substances:

[97] See ĪPV, vol. II, p. 177: *yat tu prameyadaśāpatitaṃ na bhavati kiṃ tu cidrūpatayā prakāśa-paramārtharūpaṃ cidekasvabhāvaṃ svaccham, tatra bhedābhedarūpatopalabhyate. anubhavād eva hi svacchasyādarśāder akhaṇḍitasvasvabhāvasyaiva parvatamataṅgajādirūpasahasrasaṃbhinnaṃ vapur upapadyate.* "However, [we] perceive [the property of] having a form [that includes both] difference and identity in that which has not fallen to the state of an object of knowledge, but rather, has as its form the ultimate reality that is the manifesting [consciousness] (*prakāśa*) because it consists in consciousness (*cit*), [and is] limpid (*svaccha*) [because] its nature is nothing but consciousness. For it is experience itself [that makes us know that] the form of a limpid [entity] such as a mirror can be differentiated into innumerable forms—such as a mountain, and elephant and so on—while its own nature remains perfectly intact." On the lengthy description of the mirror's capacity to reflect that follows, see Ratié (2011a, pp. 284–289). Abhinavagupta concludes it thus (ibid., p. 178): *tasmān nirmalatāmāhātmyam etad yad anantāvabhāsasaṃbhedaś caikatā ca. giriśikharoparivartinaś caikatraiva bodhe nagaragatapadārthasa-hasrābhāsa iti cidrūpasyaiva kartṛtvam upapannam, abhinnasya bhedāveśasahiṣṇutvena kriyāśaktyāveśasaṃbhavāt.* "Therefore the sovereign power (*māhātmya*) [called] 'limpidity' is both a differentiation into innumerable manifestations, and unity. And [somebody] standing on the top of a mountain [embraces] in one single cognition the manifestation of the innumerable things found in a city; therefore agency is possible only for that which consists in consciousness, because [only consciousness] can possess the power of action, since [only consciousness] is capable of assuming differentiation [while remaining] undifferentiated."

[98] See above, fn. 71.

It is not so, because we acknowledge that with the exception of this [manifestation], in all other [cases], there is [only] a production of an [already] existing [effect]. [And] in other [systems,] one does not have to postulate that one [given principle] must equal[ly apply to everything]. For according to the Vaiśeṣikas, agency is established with respect to the Lord [only, but] why is it not so for the earth and other [substances]? In the Buddhist [system], cognition is established to be that which manifests itself and [something] else, [but] why is it that no other [entity] external [to consciousness], such as visible thing, can be so? [And] the [Mīmāṃsakas] claim that necessarily, the only means of [valid] of knowledge as regards *dharma* is [Vedic] injunction[, and not perception for instance.] Therefore in this [system of ours as well,] one does not have to postulate that one [given principle] equal[ly applies] to the various [means and objects of knowledge].[99]

Utpaladeva explains the argument in the following way:

That which you have stated cannot be legitimately held, because first of all, with the exception of this manifestation, we admit that [any] other effect is indeed [already] existing. For in each system, every point does not have to be equal[ly valid with respect to everything]. To explain: among Vaiśeṣikas [it is admitted that] only the Lord is the creator of the universe, whereas a substance such as earth and so on is not [admitted to be such an agent]. In the Buddhist system it is cognition that manifests itself and [something] else, [namely its object], whereas a visible thing for instance is not [considered to be capable of thus manifesting itself and something else]. The Mīmāṃsakas claim that necessarily, only [Vedic] injunction is a means of [valid] knowledge with regard to *dharma*, [when stating] '*dharma* is whatever beneficial matter known through [Vedic] injunction [alone]',[100] whereas [they do not consider] perception and so on as [valid means of knowledge regarding *dharma*]. Therefore for [any] other [system] as well as [for ours,] one should not commit the fault of equal[ly applying] to the various means and objects of knowledge, which have one [particular] characteristic, one single [principle] regarded as having a different characteristic. Therefore [we can rightly state that] all things are effects while existing [before the causal operation, and that] nonetheless manifestation is an effect that does not exist [before the caual operation], just as [in the Mīmāṃsakas' system, the fact that Vedic] injunction is [a means of valid knowledge] with respect to *dharma* does not [entail that] the other means of knowledge [should also be valid with respect to *dharma*, or] just as, [in the Vaiśeṣikas' system, the fact that] the substance that is the Lord [is the cause of

[99] ŚD 4.37cd–41a: *naivaṃ yasmāt tāṃ vihāya sarvatrānyatra satkriyā // ity abhyupagamo'smākaṃ naikenānyatra tulyatā / kalpyā vaiśeṣikāṇāṃ hi kartṛtaiveśvare sthitā // tadvan na kiṃ pṛthivyāder bauddhe jñānam avasthitam / svānyaprakāśakaṃ nānyat tadvad anyan na kiṃ bhavet // bāhyaṃ rūpādi jalpanti pramāṇaṃ codanaiva te / niyamād dharmaviṣaye tasmān naikena tulyatā // bahūnāṃ kalpanīyātra…*

[100] MS 1.1.2.

> the universe] does not [entail that] a substance such as the earth should [also] be the cause of the universe.[101]

At first sight, the argument sounds rather weak: in the philosophical systems invoked as similar examples, the restriction of one principle to some particular logical, epistemological or ontological category does not involve any internal contradiction, whereas in the case at hand, *the manifestation of the effect can in turn be regarded as a particular effect* produced by a particular cause, so that one does not see why the principle that the effect must exist before the operation of the cause should not apply to manifestation as well as to any other effect. But as Utpaladeva explains, the argument does not amount to some arbitrary opinion, since Somānanda endeavours to justify it[102] by explaining that the *abhivyakti* of the pot does not exist apart from the pot: *one cannot consider it as an effect distinct from the effect that it manifests*, because when a pot is produced, there is no production of a manifestation of the pot that would be nonexistent before the operation of the pot's cause and distinct from the pot, so that the opponent cannot ask whether the manifestation, regarded as an effect, is in turn existing or not before the operation of the cause, for the simple reason that there is no such effect as a "manifestation of the pot" that would exist independently of the effect "pot". Somānanda thus states:

> And this manifestation (*vyakti*) does not exist apart (*vyatirekataḥ*) from things: [it is] the pot [that] is said to be "manifested"; therefore it is the very [pot] that has its nature manifested, [and it] is not distinct from manifestation.[103]

Utpaladeva explains:

> For sure, such a manifestation [of e.g. the pot] does not exist apart from the object, because it is not perceived thus [i.e. apart from the object]. And [we] talk and act (*vyavahāra*) without [making] any distinction [between them]. To explain: the pot is said to be manifested, without being distinguished from manifestation. Therefore it is the thing itself that has its nature manifested. And this [thing] is "produced" while already existing, but there is no

[101] ŚDV, p. 163: *tvaduktam eva na yuktaṃ yasmāt tām abhivyaktiṃ varjayitvānyat sad eva kāryam ity asmākaṃ tāvad abhyupagamaḥ. na hi sarvatra darśane sarvair evārthais tulyair bhāvyam. tathā hi vaiśeṣikeṣv īśvara eva viśvakartā, na tu pṛthivyādi dravyam. bauddhadarśane jñānam eva svaparaprakāśakaṃ na rūpādi. te jaiminīyā jalpanti codanaiva niyamena dharmaviṣaye pramāṇaṃ codanālakṣaṇo'rtho dharma iti, na tu pratyakṣādikam. tasmād bahūnām ekalakṣaṇānāṃ pramāṇāṃ prameyāṇāṃ vā naikena bhinnalakṣaṇābhimatenānyasyāpi tulyatāpādanadoṣa udbhāvanīyaḥ. tena sarveṣām arthānāṃ satām eva kāryatā, tathāpy abhivyaktir asaty eva*[1] *kāryā, yathā dharme na codanāvad anyāny api pramāṇāni, yathā neśvaradravyavat pṛthivyādidravyam api viśvakāraṇam.* [[1]*asaty eva* conj.: *asatyaiva* ŚDV.]

[102] See ŚDV, p. 163: *upapattir api cātrāsti, nābhyupagamamātram.* "And there is a rational justification for this, it is not a mere opinion."

[103] ŚD 4.41b–42ab: *na ca sā*[1] *vyatirekataḥ / vyaktiḥ sthitā padārthānāṃ ghaṭo vyakto'bhidhīyate // tasmāt sa eva vyaktātmā na vyakter vyatiriktatā /* [[1]*sā* conj.: *vā* ŚD, J2.]

> production of a manifestation that would be nonexistent [before the operation of the cause and] distinct [from the object].[104]

Utpaladeva is here alluding to a demonstration that constitutes the very heart of his Pratyabhijñā treatise, namely, Chap. 1.5, in which he justifies the Śaiva nondualistic thesis that nothing exists outside of consciousness: his assertion that manifestation does not exist apart from the object "because it is not perceived thus" (*tathānupalambhāt*) echoes the famous Dharmakīrtian argument of the "necessity [for the object] of being perceived together with [its cognition]" (*sahopalambhaniyama*) of which Utpaladeva himself makes great use in his Pratyabhijñā treatise so as to establish his absolute idealism.[105] The opponent of the *satkāryavāda* cannot ask about the manifestation the question that he has already asked about the effect, because the manifestation of the effect is not a second, distinct entity that would exist apart from the effect itself. If he nonetheless insists on considering this manifestation as an effect, he has to admit that this effect is not different from the nature of the already existing pot, so that the principle of the *satkāryavāda* in fact equally applies to manifestation itself:

> Alternatively, [let us consider that] a lamp produces the manifestation of e. g. a pot that [already] exists; [in such a case,] just as [one can say that] there is a production that is a manifestation of the existing [pot,] in the same way, [one can also say that] there is a production of [its] manifestation, while [this manifestation already] exists. And [thus] since [in fact] the single [principle of the *satkāryavāda*] equal[ly applies not only to the effect but also] to another [thing, namely manifestation,] there is no arising whatsoever of a nonexistent [effect in any case. Otherwise,] with respect to what would [the causes] occur, since their [very] nature [of causes] could not exist [when they are supposed to act]?[106]

When one says for instance that a lamp produces the manifestation of the pot, in fact the object on which the action of the lamp is exerted is still the pot itself, which is made manifest; therefore the pot remains the effect (the effect being literally, in Sanskrit, that on which action is exerted, *kārya*), and the manifestation of the pot is nothing but the manifested form of this already existing pot, a manifestation which, according to the Śaivas, is simply the nature of the pot, since the nondualists refuse to acknowledge any distinction of nature between an object and its phenomenon. Somānanda does not state explicitly that

[104] ŚDV, pp. 163–164: *tathābhivyaktis tāvan nārthād vyatirekeṇa sthitā tathānupalambhāt. abhedenaiva ca vyavahāraḥ. tathā hi ghaṭo vyakto'bhidhīyate vyaktyabhedena. tasmāt padārtha eva vyaktātmā. sa ca san kriyate, na tu vyakter vyatiriktāyā asatyāḥ karaṇam.*

[105] On Utpaladeva's demonstration that nothing exists apart from consciousness (and on the complex use that he makes of Buddhist arguments in this demonstration), see Ratié (2010a; 2011a, pp. 307–476; 2011b). On his use of the s*ahopalambhaniyama* argument in particular, see Ratié (2010a, pp. 439–446; 2011a, pp. 345–366).

[106] ŚD 4.42cd–44ab: *dīpena kriyate vyaktir ghaṭādeḥ sata eva vā // yathā sataḥ kriyā vyaktir vyakteḥ*[1] *sattve tathā kṛtiḥ / ekenāparatulyatvān na caivāsata*[2] *udbhavaḥ // kim āśritya pravartante tadabhāvasvarūpataḥ /* [[1]*vyakteḥ* conj. Franco confirmed by J2: *vyakte* ŚD. [2]*na caivāsata* conj.: *na ca vāsata* ŚD, J2.]

the Sāṃkhyas cannot provide such an answer to the criticism of *abhivyakti*, but his intention is obviously to show that this reply is possible *only provided that one accepts his own metaphysical presuppositions*, because according to the Sāṃkhyas, although the pot already exists in the clay before the operation of the causes enabling its arising, it cannot exist in a manifested state before the operation of the causes: it has to exist in the clay in some completely unmanifest state. This means that in the Sāṃkhya perspective, the pot and its manifestation have to be essentially distinct realities capable of existing apart from each other, but then the Sāṃkhyas leave themselves open to the objection of the *asatkāryavādin*-s, precisely because the *abhivyakti* can only be understood as something new and ontologically distinct from the effect it manifests, and therefore contradictory with the *satkāryavāda* principle. On the other hand, if, as Somānanda contends, the pot is nothing but the universal consciousness manifesting itself in the form of the pot, and if the pot does not exist apart from its manifestation, then the manifestation of the pot ceases to be problematic, since the very essence of the pot, namely, the universal consciousness, is always manifest, as Utpaladeva explains:

> [In fact] this [production of the manifestation] is not new at all.[107] For [when we say] "the lamp produces the manifestation of e.g. an already existing pot", [in fact] it is the thing itself[, i.e. the pot,] that is acted upon [and therefore constitutes the effect of the action]. And so just as [one can say that] there is a production called the "manifestation" of an existing [effect] such as the pot, in the same way, [one can say] that there is a production by a lamp for instance of the manifestation itself, which[, insofar as it is regarded as an effect, merely] consists in the thing [itself, so that just as the thing itself, it] already exists; or [one can say that there is a production] by a seed for instance of [a manifestation] consisting in a sprout. Therefore the thesis that the effect exists [before the operation of its cause] is equal[ly applied] to everything, since even manifestation, insofar as it is not distinct from the [object that it manifests], is equivalent with the [already] existing effect that is the thing. And manifestation is the fact that the sprout for instance is manifest, [i.e.] the fact that [it] consists in the manifesting [agent] (*prakāśa*)[108]; it is the existence (*avasthāna*) in this or that form of the manifesting [agent] that is consciousness, [a manifesting agent] that is devoid of beginning or end (*anādinidhana*), [i.e.] that [always] already exists—this is how the proponent of manifestation

[107] I assume that this is the meaning of *naiva tad apūrvam*; however, it could also be taken as meaning that the very thesis just expounded (namely, the idea that manifestation of the object does not exist apart from the manifested object) is not at all unheard of, since as Utpaladeva explains immediately afterwards, we can consider both that the lamp makes the pot manifest and that it produces the manifestation of the pot.

[108] The term *prakāśa* (literally, "light") is used by the Śaiva nondualists to denote the power that consciousness has of manifesting things while manifesting itself. In this particular context I have translated this untranslatable term as "manifesting [agent]", but it should be kept in mind that the term denotes both what manifests itself and the resulting "illumination" for the manifested entity—an ambiguity on which the Śaiva philosophers play since they argue that manifestation can only occur if the manifesting and the manifested entities are one and the same reality.

(*abhivyakti*) expresses the thesis that the effect exists [before the operation of its cause].[109]

The *Abhivyakti* Regarded as an Effect is Nothing New

So to sum up, if the pot is nothing but an eternal consciousness manifesting itself in the form of a pot, the *satkāryavāda* principle can apply to the manifestation of the pot as well as to the pot itself, because the essence of this manifestation is the everlasting consciousness manifesting itself in that particular form.

Admittedly, this theory seems to involve a major defect, since we do not *always* see pots: obviously, in the ordinary world, the pot is not eternally manifest, and as a matter of fact the whole controversy over the ontological status of the object has to do with the fact that some entities called "effects" sometimes arise after the arising of some other entities regarded as "causes". The Śaivas claim to solve this problem by saying that the effect is always manifest *in some way, even when it is not perceptible to the individual consciousnesses as a sensory object*, because the all-powerful universal consciousness must be ever conscious that it manifests the whole universe by taking its shape—just as when we imagine an apple, we remain aware that our consciousness creates the apple by merely taking its shape or its aspect (*ākāra*). Thus according to them, the universal consciousness is always aware of all possible effects as internal manifestations (i.e., as mere aspects that it takes on),[110] and yet sometimes, this or that object also appears to the individuals as being external to them[111]: it then becomes, as Utpaladeva says in *Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikā* 2.4.4, an object of knowledge for the sense organs.

[109] ŚDV, pp. 164–165: *naiva tad apūrvam. pradīpena hi ghaṭādeḥ sata evābhivyaktiḥ kriyata iti padārtha eva kriyate. tataś ca yathā sato ghaṭāder vyaktisaṃjñā kriyā tathā vyakter api padārtharūpāyāḥ satyā eva pradīpādinā kṛtiḥ, bījādinā vāṅkurarūpāyā iti sarvatra tulyaḥ satkāryavādaḥ. yataḥ padārthena satā kāryeṇa vyakter api tadabhinnāyās tulyatvam. vyaktiś ca prakāśamānatā prakāśātmatāṅkurāder anādinidhanasya sata eva citprakāśasya tena tenātmanāvasthānam ity abhivyaktivādinā satkāryavāda ukto bhavati.*

[110] Utpaladeva has shown earlier in the treatise (see ĪPK 1.5.10 and its commentaries) that all the entities appearing as external objects of knowledge must eternally exist in the form of a purely internal manifestation: the potter's desire to create a pot with specific properties involves a specific representation of the pot, and this specific representation is in turn the result of a creation through imagination that must be determined by a desire to create a specific imaginary representation (i.e. the imaginary representation of a pot rather than that of a cloth or any other object), and the only way to avoid an infinite regress from desire to creation and from creation to desire is to postulate that all objects are eternally apprehended by the universal consciousness as being one with it or internal to it. On this demonstration, too lengthy to be examined here, see Ratié (2011a, pp. 480–495).

[111] See ĪPK 1.8.7: *cinmayatve'vabhāsānām antar eva sthitiḥ sadā / māyayā bhāsamānānāṃ bāhyatvād bahir apy asau //* "Phenomena always have an existence that is *internal*, because [they] consist in consciousness; [but] this [existence] is also external due to the externality of the [entities] manifested by *māyā*." Cf. ĪPV, vol. I, pp. 331–332: *ihāvabhāsānāṃ sadaiva bāhyatābhāsatadabhāvayor apy antar eva pramātṛprakāśa eva sthitiḥ, yata ete cinmayāḥ, anyathā naiva prakāśerann ity uktaṃ yataḥ. yadā tu māyāśaktyā vicchedanāvabhāsanasvātantryarūpayā bāhyatvam eṣām ābhāsyate, tadā tad avalambyāvabhāsamānānām asau sthitir bahir apy antar api. nāyam āntarābhāso bāhyatvasya virodhī pratyuta sarvābhāsabhittibhūto'sau, tat kathaṃ virodha iti yuktam uktaṃ sadaivāntarāṇāṃ satteti.* "In this [world,] phenomena always have an existence that is *internal*—[i.e., they have an existence] in the sole

Now, the opponent of the *satkāryavāda* might argue that by stating this, the nondualist Śaiva confesses that there is indeed something *new*, since he considers that objects are always manifest as internal forms of consciousness, but he also admits that their manifestation in an external form—as objects of the individuals' sensory organs—only takes place occasionally. And this, once again, could be considered a breach of the rule that no nonexistent entity can come to exist: the external form of the object at least seems to be some new property that did not exist before the causal operation. But the Śaivas answer that this manifestation of the object as an entity external to consciousness is in fact nothing new.

In order to understand how the Śaivas can afford to give such an answer, we have to keep in mind that according to them, when we perceive a pot as an entity external to us, our awareness is an erroneous perception (*bhrānti*)[112]: in fact the pot is always manifest as an internal form of the universal consciousness, but we fail to grasp it as such, just as, when we see a pot in a mirror without noticing that it is a mere reflection because we do not pay attention to the reflecting background (*bhitti*) on which it is manifest, we are mistaken in thinking that the pot has an independent existence. When we see a face in front of us and then suddenly realize that it is only a reflection of ourselves in a mirror, we are first mistaken inasmuch as we consider the face as something endowed with an independent existence: we first think that someone else is present because we do not notice that the face only exists on the background of the mirror that reflects it. And yet the surface of the mirror and the fact that the face is a mere reflection, i.e. an image that does not exist apart from the mirror, were just as manifest before we had this realization: we were already perceiving the face as well as the surface of the mirror and their essential nondifference (*abheda*) before realizing what this face is, but we were not paying attention to this nondifference. In the same way, according to the Śaivas, when we see a pot that has just been created by a potter, we simply fail to see that in fact the pot is only manifest on the background (*bhitti*) of consciousness, or is a mere aspect that consciousness assumes. So the manifestation of the pot as an external entity grasped by our sense organs is nothing but a "nonapprehension of [its] identity [with consciousness]" (*abhedākhyāti*). That is, it is not some new manifestation, nor the manifestation of something new, but merely an incomplete apprehension of an ever present manifestation. In his commentary on the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, Utpaladeva repeatedly explains that the effect as he defines it, namely, as an object of knowledge that

Footnote 111 continued
manifesting consciousness (*prakāśa*) of the knowing subject, whether there is a manifestation of externality or not, because they consist in consciousness; since [we] have [already] explained that otherwise, they could not be manifest at all. However, when, due to the power of *māyā* that consists in the freedom (*svātantrya*) of manifesting the separation (*vicchedana*) [of things from consciousness], their externality is manifested, then, with respect to this [externality manifested by the power of *māyā*,] the existence of the manifested [entities] is both external and internal. [And] this internal manifestation is not contradictory with externality; rather, it is the background (*bhitti*) of all phenomena—therefore how could there be any contradiction? So [Utpaladeva] has rightly said that [things] always exist [as being] internal [to consciousness]."

[112] On theories of error found in the works of Somānanda, Utpaladeva and Abhinavagupta, see Rastogi (1986) and Nemec (2012).

appears to be external, is a mere *abhedākhyāti*.[113] In his commentary on the *Tantrāloka*, Jayaratha also makes it clear that this notion of *abhedākhyāti* is precisely what enables the Śaivas to answer the criticism of *abhivyakti* formulated by the opponents of the *satkāryavāda*: he explains that one cannot ask whether the manifestation of an effect exists or not before the operation of the cause, because in the Śaiva nondualistic system, the object is manifested both as being internal and as being external,[114] so that being an effect is nothing but the fact that an object appears as if it were external to consciousness, and this manifestation as something external is nothing new, because it is a mere nonapprehension of the ever manifest interiority of the object, or of its identity with the ultimate consciousness.[115]

It is certainly this type of explanation that Abhinavagupta has in mind when stating in his commentary on *Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikā* 2.4.4 that one cannot rightfully ask whether being an object of knowledge for the sense organs is in turn some property that already exists or not before the operation of the cause: he takes the examples of a pot reflected in a mirror or perceived in a dream to show that in such cases, the object apprehended as external *is in fact manifested as being internal* (to the mirror, or the dreaming consciousness) and that for this reason the

[113] See e.g. ŚDV, p. 173: *evam asmaddarśana īśvarapratyabhijñoktanītyā yathobhayendriyavedyatvaṃ śivābhedākhyātimayam arthānāṃ karaṇam, tathā vināśa ubhayendriyavedyatvābhāvaḥ śivābhedaḥ śivatvena pracchādanaṃ.* "Thus in our system, according to the principle that [I have already] stated in the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* [treatise], just as the production of objects is [nothing but the property of] being an object of knowledge for both [external and internal] sense organs, [a property that] consists in the [mere] nonapprehension of the non-difference with Śiva (*śivābhedākhyāti*), in the same way, the destruction [of objects] is the [mere property of] not being an object for both [internal and external] sense organs, [a property that is] not distinct from Śiva [either and that is] the concealment (*pracchādana*) [of Śiva's nature] as being Śiva." Cf. e.g. ŚDV, p. 174: *antarasthita evendriyavedyo'bhedākhyātimayaḥ kriyata iti pūrvam uktam.* "[We] have already explained that [the pot] is produced [insofar as it becomes] an object for the sense organs, which is nothing but a nonapprehension of the non-difference [with consciousness], only if [this pot] exists within [consciousness]."

[114] See TĀV, vol. VI, p. 10: *tasmāc cidrūpa eva parameśvaraḥ svecchāvaśād iyad viśvam avabhāsayati, kiṃtu niyatidaśāyāṃ prathāntaravyavadhānena yena bījād aṅkuro mṛdo ghaṭa ityevamādyātmikā lokasya pratītiḥ. nanv evaṃ so'pi kiṃ sad asad vā viśvam avabhāsayed ity ukta eva doṣaḥ. neha khalv āntaratvagrāhyatvabāhyatvabhedāt tridhārthaḥ parisphuret, tathā hi sarvasya pramātur manogocaratvāpatter api pūrvaṃ svasaṃvidaikātmyena parisphurato'rthasyāntaratvam antarbahiṣkaraṇadvayavedyatayā ghaṭāder iva bāhyatvam apīti saṃvidātmany avasthitasya cārthasya bahiravabhāsanam ity upapāditam anyatra bahuśaḥ.* "Therefore it is the Highest Lord, whose nature is nothing but consciousness, that makes all this universe manifest by his own will; nonetheless, in the condition of necessity (*niyati*), due to the veiling (*vyavadhāna*) of the internal manifestation, people have a perception [of reality that is expressed] thus for instance: 'the sprout [arises] from the seed', 'the pot [arises] from the clay'. [— Objection:] But [if it is] so, does this [Highest Lord] in turn manifest the universe [while the universe already] exists or not? [Since we can ask this question,] the fault already levelled [against the Sāṃkhya theory of manifestation is also found in your system. — Answer:] No; for in this [system of ours,] for sure, the object can flash forth in three ways according to the difference between [its] being internal, [its] being an object of apprehension [for the internal organ] and [its] being external. To explain: even before becoming an object for the [internal organ — i.e.] the mind (*manas*) of each [limited] knowing subject—the object is internal [since it] flashes forth as being one with self-awareness (*svasaṃvit*); [but] it is also external since [an object] such as a pot is an object of knowledge for both internal and external [sense] organs. Therefore [it is] an object that [in fact] exists inside what consists in consciousness that is manifested as [being] external: this has been demonstrated in many ways elsewhere."

[115] See TĀV, vol. VI, p. 11: *na cāntaravasthitasyārthasya bahiravabhāsanaṃ nāmāpūrvaṃ kiṃcid api tv abhedākhyātimātram iti na kaścid doṣaḥ.* "And the manifestation as being external of the object which exists internally is not something that would be new (*apūrva*); rather, it is a mere nonapprehension of non-difference (*abhedākhyāti*), therefore there is no fault whatsoever [in our system]."

manifestation of the pot as external is nothing that would come to exist after being nonexistent. And that he did not take the trouble of explaining this point because it was already made clear by Utpaladeva is confirmed by the fact that in his commentary on the *Śivadṛṣṭi*, Utpaladeva specifies that he has explained in his (now lost) *Vivṛti*, by having recourse to the simile of the mirror, how the various effects are nothing but incomplete awarenesses of Śiva's nature and are therefore nothing new.[116]

Although the *Abhivyakti* is Not New, This Does Not Imply Any Infinite Regress

There is still, however, an obvious objection that comes to mind with respect to the thesis that the nondualist Śaivas present as the only solution to the problem of *abhivyakti*: as the opponent to the *satkāryavāda* has noticed, if the advocate of the *satkāryavāda* considers that the manifestation of a pot exists before the operation of the potter, how is it that the pot is not always manifest? This is the question that leads the Sāṃkhya to an infinite regress (since if the Sāṃkhya answers that the manifestation exists in some unmanifested state before the operation of its cause, he must admit that a second manifestation reveals that unmanifested manifestation, and this second manifestation in turn must be manifested by a third, etc.). As we have seen, in fact according to the Śaivas, the pot is always manifest as an internal manifestation of consciousness, and although it is ever manifest in this internal form, ordinary individual subjects only grasp it as an external form appearing in

[116] See ŚDV, pp. 13–14 (ad ŚD 1.11cd–13ab): *māyāśaktikṛtapūrṇasvarūpākhyātimayacitrakāryatāpannasvarūpaprasaraṇarasāt prabhor asya tadrūpasya kāryabhedasya kutsitatvam ayuktam. tathā hi parāparāvasthāyāṃ sadāśiveśvararūpatve viśvam aham iti viśvarūpatvam eva saṃvidi sphurati. aparāvasthāyām apy ahaṃ ghaṭam imaṃ vedmi ghaṭo'yam iti vā dvaitadṛṣṭau cidātmakatāṃ vinā prakāśamānataiva nopapadyata iti tadrūpataiva, kiṃtu māyāśaktivaśād abhedāparāmarśa iti sarvadā svarūpaprasaraṇam eveti kathaṃ garhitatvam. abhedāparāmarśanam eva bhrāntirūpaṃ kutsitaṃ tac ca na kiñcid akhyātirūpamātratvāt, na tv apūrvasya kasya cit prathā. viśvātmatvaṃ ca cinmayasya pratibimbānām iva darpaṇaparamārthatvena bhāvānāṃ svacchacinmātrasatattvatayāvasthānāt. etac ca sarvam īśvarapratyabhijñāṭīkāyāṃ nipuṇam ālocitam.* "The differentiation into [various] effects (*kāryabheda*), which has as its nature the [Lord himself,] cannot be impure, because the Lord relishes the flow of his own nature while it becomes the various effects, [and these] consist of a [mere] nonapprehension of his full nature (*pūrṇasvarūpākhyāti*) produced by the power of *māyā*. To explain: in the condition [called] "superior-and-inferior" (*parāpara*), where [consciousness] takes the form of Sadāśiva and Īśvara, it is the fact that [the Lord] takes the form of the universe that flashes forth in consciousness as 'I am the universe'. Even in the inferior (*apara*) condition, which is [that of] the dualistic view [expressed as] "I know this pot" or "this pot", since being manifest (*prakāśamānatā*) is not possible [for anything] unless [it] consists of consciousness, [everything] consists in the Lord [there too]; nonetheless, due to the power of *māyā*, there is no awareness (*parāmarśa*) of the non-difference. Therefore in all [conditions], there is nothing but the flow of [the Lord's] nature; so how could [any condition] be contemptible? Only the non-awareness of the non-difference [with the Lord's nature] consists in an erroneous cognition [and is therefore] impure, and that, [in fact,] is nothing, because it merely consists in a nonapprehension; but there is no manifestation of anything new (*apūrva*). And that which consists in consciousness takes the form of the universe, because entities exist while having as their reality nothing but a limpid consciousness, just as reflections [that only exist] while having the mirror as their ultimate reality; and [I] have skillfully shown all this in [my] detailed commentary (*Ṭīkā*[=*Vivṛti*]) on the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* [treatise]." For a somewhat different interpretation of this passage see Nemec (2011, pp. 117–118).

some specific places and at some specific times; and this is so because they fail to notice the ever manifest form of the pot as an internal form assumed by consciousness. But isn't this answer a way of getting rid of the problem without solving it? If the pot is always manifest as an internal form of consciousness, why is it not always apprehended as such? How can we fail to perceive something that is precisely nothing but a manifestation?

The Śaivas' answer to this question lies in the original way in which they understand consciousness and its relationship to manifestation. Thus immediately before the passage in which Abhinavagupta explains that the question formulated by the opponent of the *satkāryavāda* (i.e., does the manifestation of the pot as something external preexist or not the operation of its cause?) cannot be asked when it comes to Utpaladeva's definition of causality, he says that consciousness is "beyond rational examination" (*acintya*) and "cannot be put into question" (*aparyanuyojya*).[117] For the nondualist Śaivas consider that consciousness—even the ordinary consciousness of a limited individual who is unaware that in fact (s)he is Śiva—is endowed with an extraordinary power which they call the power of *māyā* (*māyāśakti*), a power that enables it to accomplish "the most difficult deeds" (*atiduṣkara*, *atidurghaṭa*).[118] Although incomprehensible, this power has very little to do with the inexplicable (*anirvācya*) *māyā* of the Vedāntins (and the Śaivas themselves emphasize this difference), since this prodigious capacity of consciousness is something that we constantly *experience* in our most banal and ordinary states[119]—namely, the ability or the freedom (*svātantrya*) that consciousness has of hiding from itself what it somehow knows, or of not paying attention to its own nature.[120] When imagining or when dreaming for instance, our consciousness playfully conceals its own nature, the essence of which is to be self-manifest, and presents itself in the form of insentient objects—all the while it somehow remains aware that the world of insentient entities that it thus creates is nothing but consciousness, and yet it manages to forget to some extent that it is nothing but consciousness, and to produce in itself the conviction (*abhimāna*) that it is not what it really is. It is this power that enables consciousness to become so engrossed in the forms that it assumes in a dream that it forgets for a while that the objects it perceives are only manifest as forms of consciousness or on its background—it is also this power that makes the pot appear as an object external to consciousness,

[117] See above, fn. 74.

[118] See Ratié (2011a, p. 264, fn. 208). See also Bansat-Boudon and Tripathi (2011, pp. 126–129).

[119] See Ratié (2011a, pp. 562–569).

[120] See e.g. TĀ 4.9–11, which answers the objection according to which consciousness cannot present itself as an object of consciousness without losing its essential property, namely, sentiency: *ucyate svātmasaṃvittiḥ svabhāvād eva nirbharā / nāsyām apāsyaṃ nādheyaṃ kiṃcid ity uditaṃ purā // kiṃtu durghaṭakāritvāt svācchandyān nirmalād asau / svātmapracchādanakrīḍāpaṇḍitaḥ parameśvaraḥ // anāvṛte*[1] *svarūpe'pi yad ātmācchādanaṃ vibhoḥ / saiva māyā yato bheda etāvān viśvavṛttikaḥ //* [[1]*anāvṛte* corr.: *anāvṛtte* TĀ.] "[We] answer that the awareness of the Self (*svātmasaṃvitti*) [remains] full due to its very nature: [we] have already stated that nothing can be taken off from or added to it. However, because he is the agent of the most difficult deeds, out of his pure freedom, the Highest Lord is skillful at the game (*krīḍā*) that is self-concealment (*svātmapracchādana*). Concealing oneself (*ātmācchādana*) whereas one's own nature remains unveiled—this is precisely the Lord's *māyā*, from which all the diversity found [throughout] the universe comes."

whereas in fact the pot is nothing but consciousness manifesting itself as a pot, and whereas it remains manifest as such.[121] So there is no need to postulate that the manifestation of the pot remains unmanifest before the operation of its cause and must be somehow manifested by a second manifestation, etc.: in fact, consciousness is *always* manifest as the essence of the pot, but it freely and playfully chooses to *ignore* this manifestation.

Conclusion: The Centrality of the Notion of *Abhivyakti* in Utpaladeva's Reinterpretation of the *Satkāryavāda*

The Sāṃkhya concept of *abhivyakti* was designed to justify a theory of causation based on the s*atkāryavāda* principle: it enabled Sāṃkhya authors to claim both that an effect preexists the causal operation that apparently produces it, and that causes do produce something, namely, the manifestation of the effect. Yet it was obviously considered by the opponents of Sāṃkhya as the weak point of the system. As we have seen, both Brahmanical and Buddhist authors pointed out that the notion of *abhivyakti* either contradicts the s*atkāryavāda* principle or leads to an infinite regress, and the embarrassed silence of the Sāṃkhya authors in this regard might indicate that they too felt how problematic the notion was: to my knowledge, among the preserved Sāṃkhya commentaries written before Abhinavagupta or in his lifetime, only the *Tattvakaumudī* mentions the problem,[122] and Vācaspatimiśra contents himself with showing that the *asatkāryavādin* is in fact in a similar predicament, but he makes no attempt to rescue the notion of *abhivyakti* from the accusation of absurdity levelled by his opponent.[123] We should not assume, from the

[121] See e.g. ĪPVV ad ĪPK II, 3, 17, vol. 3, p. 181: *bhagavata idam eva svātantryaṃ yat paśulokāpekṣayā-tiduṣkaraṃ tatsaṃpādane'py apratīghātaḥ. itaś ca kim itarad duṣkaraṃ yat prakāśātmany eva prakāśamāna eva prakāśaniședho'prakāśamānatābhimāna eva. evaṃbhūtaṃ yat svātantryaṃ tad eva grāhakollāsanaṃ taddvāreṇa ca grāhyollāsanam api. saiṣā māyāśaktir vimohinīty[1] uktā.* [[1]*vimohinī* corr.: *vimohanīti* ĪPVV.] "This is precisely what the Lord's freedom (*svātantrya*) is: the absence of any impediment even in accomplishing what is extremely difficult to do (*atiduṣkara*) from the point of view of enslaved individuals. And what could be more difficult to do than this: negating manifestation (*prakāśa*) —which is nothing but the conviction (*abhimāna*) that one is not manifest—with respect to [the Self, whereas it] must be manifest, [since] it consists precisely in manifestation? It is this freedom that makes the apprehending subject (*grāhaka*) arise, and through this [apprehending subject], the apprehended object as well; it is the power of *māyā* of which [they] say that it deludes."

[122] See above, fn. 69. Vācaspatimiśra had already written his *Ṭīkā* on Uddyotakara's NV by the time he wrote the TK, and the NV might be his (or at least one of his) source(s) as regards the *abhivyakti* dilemma.

[123] See TK, pp. 102–104: *athāsad utpadyata iti keyam asata utpattiḥ saty asatī vā, satī cet kṛtaṃ karaṇena, asatī cet tatrāpy utpattyantaram ity anavasthā. athotpattiḥ paṭān nārthāntaram api tu paṭa evāsau, tathāpi yāvad uktam bhavati paṭa iti tāvad uktam bhavaty utpadyata iti. tataś ca paṭa ity ukta utpadyata iti na vācyam paunaruktyād vinaśyatīty api na vācyaṃ virodhāt. tasmād iyam paṭotpattiḥ svakāraṇasamavāyo vā svasattāsamavāyo vobhayathāpi notpadyate.* "But in [your own thesis, according to which] a nonexistent [thing] arises, what is this arising of a nonexistent [thing]? Is [this arising already] existing or not [before the operation of the cause]? If [you answer that this arising] exists [before the operation of the cause, [then] the [very notion of] production is over; [but] if it is nonexistent, with respect to that [arising] too, there [must be] another arising, [and this arising of the arising requires a third arising, etc.,] so that [there is] an infinite regress. But if [our opponent replies that] the arising [of a cloth] is not something different from the cloth, but rather, is the cloth itself, even so, as soon as [he] says 'cloth', [he

fact that verses 2.4.3–4 in the Pratyabhijñā treatise do not mention this notion of *abhivyakti*, that it was not an important aspect of Utpaladeva's interpretation of the *satkāryavāda*: Somānanda had already emphasized that it constituted the main weakness of the Sāṃkhya position, and although Abhinavagupta's commentaries on the Pratyabhijñā treatise only mention the theory of *abhivyakti* in a particularly elliptical way, it is highly probable that they do so only because the matter was already made clear in Utpaladeva's lost *Vivṛti*, and because Utpaladeva's reasoning there rested on Somānanda's in the *Śivadṛṣṭi*. Abhinavagupta, while discussing another point related to the Sāṃkhya notion of *abhivyakti*, thus emphasizes that the main goal of the nondualist Śaivas in appropriating the Sāṃkhya *satkāryavāda* is to show that the relationship between the Sāṃkhya notions of potentiality (*śakti*) and manifestation (*vyakti/abhivyakti*) can only make sense if they are interpreted along Śaiva nondualistic lines:

> Therefore it is only in the doctrine of the nonduality [of everything with] consciousness (*cidadvayavāda*), [i.e.,] if one acknowledges that all entities consist in reflections (*pratibimba*) in the mirror of consciousness, that the distinction between potentiality (*śakti*) and manifestation (*vyakti*) becomes possible, [since this distinction is then understood as] having as its real nature the acts of folding (*nimeṣaṇa*) and unfolding (*unmeṣaṇa*) [through which consciousness conceals and manifests its nature[124] and] which take [infinitely] variegated appearances (*citrita*) thanks to the power of consciousness—and not otherwise.[125]

The Sāṃkhya notion of *śakti* eventually boils down to the idea that *things can exist apart from their manifestation*, since for the Sāṃkhyas it designates the unmanifested state in which the effect exists before the cause reveals it, or the state in which the effect *could be* manifested but is not. It is therefore no wonder that the dualist Śaivas, the Saiddhāntikas, have adopted not only the principle of the *satkāryavāda* but also the Sāṃkhya distinction between *śakti* and *abhivyakti*[126]: the latter distinction fits with a dualistic system in which things and their phenomena can exist apart from each other. And yet, as Somānanda and Utpaladeva point out, this distinction remains problematic in a dualistic system, because the manifestation of the effect can be regarded as a reality distinct from the effect itself and therefore subjected to the alternative of existence or nonexistence, and if the advocate of the *satkāryavāda* chooses to say that this manifestation already exists before the

Footnote 123 continued
has] already said [that it] 'arises', and therefore, since [he has already] said 'cloth', [he] cannot say that [this cloth] arises, because [otherwise] the [fault of] redundancy [would ensue for him], and [he] cannot say that it perishes either, because of the contradiction [that would ensue between 'cloth' and 'perishing' if 'cloth' means 'arising']. Therefore this arising of the cloth, whether it has an inherence in its own cause or an inherence in its own existence, or even both, [can]not arise."

[124] *nimeṣa/nimeṣaṇa* and *unmeṣa/unmeṣaṇa* are two untranslatable terms usually denoting the movement through which eyes (or flowers) close and open, and more generally, the folding or concealment of that which has the power to appear, and the disclosure or unfolding of that which has the power to hide.

[125] ĪPVV, vol. II, pp. 312–313: *tasmāc cidadvayavāda eva saṃviddarpaṇapratibimbarūpe bhāva-kalāpe'bhyupagamyamāne śaktivyaktivibhāgaḥ saṃvicchakticitritanimeṣaṇonmeṣaṇaparamārtha upapa-dyate, nānyathā.*

[126] See above, fn. 4, 44 and 91.

operation of the cause so as to save the *satkāryavāda*, he must either contradict his own principle that the effect only exists in some *unmanifest* state before the operation of the cause, or admit that the *manifestation* of the pot is already present in the clay and nonetheless *is manifest for nobody*. The problem vanishes in the idealistic system of the Pratyabhijñā, because the pot can be ever manifest as an internal form grasped by the absolute consciousness and yet remain unperceived as an external form for the various limited individuals, and because even when the pot becomes perceptible as an external form for the limited individuals, this manifestation is nothing new, but only amounts to the individuals' limited awareness of the ever manifest internal form of the pot.

While criticizing the way in which the Sāṃkhyas understand the distinction between potentiality and manifestation, the Śaiva nondualists might thus be implicitly targetting by the same token their dualist cousins: whereas a Saiddhāntika scripture such as the *Mṛgendratantra* adopts the theory of *abhivyakti* but shows no knowledge of the dilemma that the *asatkāryavādin*-s oppose to this theory and that the Śaiva nondualists exploit, his commentator Nārāyaṇakaṇṭha (an important Saiddhāntika author who had read Utpaladeva)[127] seems to be painfully aware of it. Quite amusingly, he justifies this scriptural silence as an expression of contempt for a purely sophistic argument,[128] but the way in which he himself attempts to overcome this difficulty seems to leave unresolved the problematic statement that the effect's manifestation preexists in some unmanifest state.[129] The nondualist

[127] As noted in Sanderson (2006, p. 45), MTṬ ad MT, *Vidyāpāda* 1.1, pp. 30–31, quotes ĪS 55.

[128] MTṬ, pp. 201–202: *abhivyaktir api kim asat kāryam uta netyevamādikutārkikakuvikalpaparihāro granthavistarabhīrutvān na likhitaḥ.* "As for the refutation of such a bad dilemma [formulated by] bad logicians as this: '[but this] manifestation in turn, is it an effect that is nonexistent [before the operation of the factors of action] or not?', it has not been written [here] for fear of [making] the text [too] long."

[129] See MTṬ, p. 202: *vyaktisvarūpatvād abhivyakter abhivyaṅgyatā, na vetyādayaḥ kila vitarkā dūrāpetā eva prakāśavat. yathā hi prakāśaḥ prakāśātmakatvān na prakāśāntaraprakāśyaḥ, evam abhivyaktir vyaktisvabhāvatvān nābhivyaktyantaram apekṣata iti.* "The sophisms (*vitarka*) such as 'does manifestation have to be manifested (*abhivyaṅgya*) or not?' are immediately refuted by the [mere] fact that [manifestation] consists in manifestation, just as light. For just as light, because it consists in light, does not have to be illuminated by some other light, in the same way, manifestation, because it has as its nature manifestation, does not require another manifestation." Nārāyaṇakaṇṭha tries to avoid the accusation of infinite regress (the preexisting manifestation does not need to be manifested by a second manifestation, etc., because its very nature is to be manifest), which seems to indicate that he considers that the *abhivyakti* of the effect preexists the operation of the cause, but he does not address the problem of the nature of this *preexisting manifestation that remains unmanifest* as long as the conditions for manifestation are not present. Cf. MTD, p. 250: *kiṃ cābhivyakter api tatsahakārisannidhau tadvyaktisvabhāvatvenāsyābhivyakter*[1] *abhyupagamāt satītve na doṣaḥ kaścit.* [[1]*tadvyaktisvabhāvatvenābhivyakter* conj.: *tadvyaktesvabhāvatvenābhivyakter* MTD.] "Moreoever, since [we] admit that the manifestation of the [pot] when its auxiliary causes are present is also [the manifestation] of this manifestation [itself,] because [manifestation] has as its [very] nature this manifestation [of itself as well as of the object it manifests,] there is no fault whatsoever in [saying that the manifestation] exists [before the operation of the factors of action]." The passage is difficult and my interpretation might be wrong (for a somewhat different interpretation see Hulin 1980, p. 215); at any rate it seems to me that Aghoraśiva is explaining Nārāyaṇakaṇṭha's argument by saying that since the very nature of manifestation is to manifest itself as well as its object, stating that the manifestation of the pot exists before the factors of action act does not lead to any infinite regress because by nature manifestation manifests itself. But here too, the problem of the status of this preexisting and yet unmanifest manifestation does not seem to be addressed, at least as far as I understand the passage.

Śaivas, on the other hand, can afford to solve the problem of *abhivyakti* by merely playing with the two principles that constitute the very foundation of their metaphysics: everything is a manifestation of consciousness, and the essence of consciousness is a freedom to apprehend itself as what it is not without ceasing to be itself. The Sāṃkhya/Saiddhāntika notion of potentiality (*śakti*) thus gets filled with a completely different meaning: it no longer designates a latent, unmanifest and passive state, but rather, the ever manifest power that consciousness has of concealing itself while remaining manifest—a power that eventually is just another way for consciousness of manifesting itself, so that for the nondualist Śaivas, *śakti* and *abhivyakti* are only two different aspects of the same reality: the pure dynamism of consciousness.

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[S1] *Īśvarapratyabhijñāvimarśinī*. Śrinagar: Oriental Research Library, n° 816 = DSO 00001 5659 [*śāradā* script].
[S2] *Īśvarapratyabhijñāvimarśinī*. Śrinagar: Oriental Research Library, n° 1035 = DSO 00001 8219 [*śāradā* script].
[S8] *Īśvarapratyabhijñāvimarśinī*. Śrinagar: Oriental Research Library, n° 1037 = DSO 00001 8222 [*śāradā* script].
[SOAS] *Īśvarapratyabhijñāvimarśinī* ("*Pratyabhijñāsūtra* with Abhinavagupta's *Sūtrārthavimarśinī*"). London: School of Oriental and African Studies Library, n° 207 in R.C Dogra's 1978 catalogue/MS n° 44255 [*śāradā* script].

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[JM = *Jayamaṅgalā*] See SK.

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[MS = *Mīmāṃsāsūtra*] See Frauwallner 1968.

[MŚV 1 = *Mālinīślokavārttika* 1.1-399] *Abhinavagupta's Philosophy of Revelation. An Edition and Annotated Translation of Mālinīślokavārttika I, 1–399*, by J. Hanneder. Groningen: Egbert Forsten (Groningen Oriental Studies 14).

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[MV = *Māṭharavṛtti*] See SK.

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[NBhūṣ = *Nyāyabhūṣaṇa*] *Śrīmadācārya-Bhāsarvajña-praṇītasya Nyāyasārasya svopanjñaṃ vyākhyānaṃ Nyāyabhūṣaṇam*, edited by S. Yogīndrānanda. Varanasi: Ṣaḍdarśan Prakāśan Pratiṣṭhānam, 1968.

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[NS = *Nyāyasūtra*] See NV.

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[*Vṛtti = Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikāvṛtti*] See ĪPK.
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